

UNIT 3

SECTION A — Short Answer Questions (2 Marks Each)

Family as the Basic Unit of Human Interaction

Q1. What is meant by 'family as the basic unit of human interaction'?

Answer: Every human being is born in a family and is part of a family. The family is the basic unit or building block of human organisation. It provides a base for appreciating, accepting, understanding and

practicing to live in relationship and harmony (order).

Q2. What is the basis for harmony in the family?

Answer: The harmony in the family has primarily to do with the fulfilment of relationship between one human being and the other human being. In order to fulfil relationship, it is necessary to understand relationship — particularly the feelings in relationship, which are in the Self, not in the Body.

Family as the Basic Unit of Human Interaction

Q3. Mention two characteristics of a healthy family.

Answer: (1) **Trust on intention** among all the members — when a member lacks competence, the others help and support rather than oppose, because they do not doubt each other's intention. (2) **Mutual sharing and right evaluation** of the naturally acceptable feelings (the nine values in relationship) — leading to mutual happiness among all the members. In a healthy family, members ensure the right feelings in themselves, share them with the others, and rightly evaluate the feelings expressed by the others.

Understanding Relationship — Four Aspects

Q4. What are the four important aspects of relationship?

Answer: (1) Relationship is between one Self (In) and another Self (In). (2) There are feelings in relationship — in one Self for the other Self. (3) These feelings can be recognised — they are definite.

(4) The fulfilment of these feelings and their right evaluation lead to mutual happiness.

Q5. What does it mean that 'relationship is between one Self and another Self'?

Answer: Relationship is already there; we do not have to construct or create it. We only need to understand and fulfil it. It is the Self (the 'I') which recognises the relationship, and not the Body. It is the

Self which relates to the other, and not the Body.

Q6. Name the nine feelings (values) in relationship.

Answer: The nine feelings are: (a) Trust (foundation value), (b) Respect, (c) Affection, (d) Care, (e) Guidance, (f) Reverence, (g) Glory, (h) Gratitude, and (i) Love (complete value). These are naturally

acceptable to us in relationship with other human beings.

Q7. How does the fulfilment of feelings in relationship lead to mutual happiness?

Answer: When we have the naturally acceptable feelings in the Self, we share them with the other. When we are both able to evaluate the feelings rightly, it leads to mutual happiness — the happiness of oneself as well as the happiness of the other.

Justice in Relationship

Q8. Define 'justice' in the context of relationship.

Answer: Justice is the recognition, fulfilment and evaluation of human-human relationship, leading to mutual happiness. Justice is desirable in the family and beyond the family, all the way to the world

family.

Q9. What does 'recognition of relationship' mean?

Answer: Recognition of relationship means recognising the naturally acceptable feelings in relationship rightly — identifying the nine feelings (trust, respect, affection, care, guidance, reverence, glory,

gratitude, love) and understanding them.

Q10. What does 'fulfilment of relationship' mean?

Answer: Fulfilment of relationship means: (1) ensuring the naturally acceptable feelings in oneself; (2) living with responsibility with the other with these feelings, making the other comfortable and assured; and (3) making effort for mutual development — developing one's own competence and helping the

other develop theirs.

Q11. What does 'evaluation' mean in the context of justice?

Answer: Evaluation means verifying that I have the right feeling, I am able to express it properly, the right feeling has reached the other, and the other is able to identify it as the right feeling. When recognition, fulfilment and evaluation are right from my side, I feel happy; when the other evaluates rightly, they also feel happy.

Appraisal of Current Status and the Way Ahead

Q12. What is the problem in relationships today (appraisal of current status)?

Answer: We assume ourselves to be the Body and assume the relationship on the basis of the Body (and not the feelings). We therefore fail to understand relationship and consequently fail to fulfil it, despite good intentions. The problems are due to absence of one or more right feelings in the Self. We try to make up this gap by physical facility or by demanding feelings from others, rather than ensuring

these feelings in ourselves.

Q13. What is 'the way ahead' for harmony in the family?

Answer: First, rightly recognise the relationship, identify the naturally acceptable feelings, understand them and ensure they are in us — this ensures happiness in us. Second, share these feelings with the other. Since this is naturally acceptable to the other as well, it leads to happiness in the other also, thus leading to mutual happiness.

Trust — The Foundational Value

Q14. Define 'trust' as a feeling in relationship.

Answer: Trust is to be assured that the other intends to make me happy and prosperous. Trust on intention (natural acceptance) is the foundation of relationship and the beginning of mutual

development.

Q15. What are the eight statements used to examine trust, and what do they relate to?

Answer: The eight statements are: (1a) Do I want to make myself happy? (1b) Am I able to make myself always happy? (2a) Do I want to make the other happy? (2b) Am I able to make the other always happy? (3a) Does the other want to make himself/herself happy? (3b) Is the other able to make himself/herself always happy? (4a) Does the other want to make me happy? (4b) Is the other able to make me always happy? Statements 1a–4a relate to intention (natural acceptance); statements 1b–4b

relate to competence (ability).

Q16. What is the difference between intention and competence in the context of trust?

Answer: Intention is what is naturally acceptable to a person — their want or desire (e.g., 'I want to make the other happy'). Competence is what a person is — their ability (e.g., 'I am able to make the other always happy'). Intention is generally positive (we all want happiness for ourselves and others),

but competence is generally lacking (we are not always able to ensure it).

Q17. What is the common mistake we make in evaluating trust?

Answer: We evaluate ourselves on the basis of our intention (and conclude that we are good), but we evaluate the other on the basis of their lack of competence (and conclude that the other wants to make us unhappy — doubting their intention). On the basis of lack of competence, we conclude about the lack

of intention of the other, leading to a feeling of opposition instead of acceptance.

Q18. What will you do if you have trust on the other's intention but the other lacks competence?

Answer: The answer is to try to improve upon their competence. This is a response indicating trust on intention. Getting irritated, angry, or having a feeling of opposition are reactions based on doubt on

intention.

Q19. What are the wrong assumptions about trust that get reinforced?

Answer: The wrong assumptions are: (1) Strangers can't be trusted. (2) Trust is developed over a long time. (3) Never trust anyone. These arise because we do not see intention and competence separately. If we can see them distinctly, we can be assured of the other's intention and make a programme of interaction with right evaluation of competence (so it is not 'blind' trust).

Respect — As the Right Evaluation

Q20. Define 'respect' as a feeling in relationship.

Answer: Respect is right evaluation. When we are rightly evaluated, we feel respected. When we are

not rightly evaluated, we feel disrespected.

Q21. What are the three ways in which disrespect can take place?

Answer: (1) Over evaluation — evaluating for more than what it is. (2) Under evaluation — evaluating for less than what it is. (3) Otherwise evaluation — evaluating for other than what it is. If any of these

three takes place, the other person feels uncomfortable and disrespected.

Q22. What is the 'minimum content of respect'?

Answer: The minimum content of respect is to see that the other is similar to me. When we evaluate on the basis of the Self, we find: (1) our purpose is the same (both want continuous happiness and prosperity), (2) our programme is the same (understanding and living in harmony at all levels), and (3) our potential is the same (both are endowed with natural acceptance and the activities of desire,

thought and expectation).

Q23. What is the first set of differentiation that leads to disrespect?

Answer: Differentiation on the basis of body — on the basis of age, gender, race and physical strength. This is based on the gross misunderstanding that human being = Body. The truth is that human being =

co-existence of the Self and the Body.

Q24. What is the second set of differentiation that leads to disrespect?

Answer: Differentiation on the basis of physical facility — on the basis of wealth and post. The gross misunderstanding here is that physical facility = happiness. The truth is that happiness is to be in a state

of harmony.

Q25. What is the third set of differentiation that leads to disrespect?

Answer: Differentiation on the basis of beliefs — on the basis of different isms (like socialism, capitalism), different sects, and different sets of information. This is founded on the misunderstanding

that if the preconditioning of the other matches mine, then the other is respectable, otherwise not. The

truth is that preconditioning and right understanding are two different things.

Q26. What is the 'complete content of respect'?

Answer: The complete content of respect is to see that the other is similar to me in terms of purpose, programme and potential, and we are complementary to each other in terms of competence. At the level of the Self, only competence could be different (how much potential has been realised). This

difference is to be complementary, not to discriminate and exploit.

Q27. How do we define one's complementarity in the complete content of respect?

Answer: If the other has more understanding and is more responsible than me, I am committed to understand from the other. If I have more understanding than the other, I live with responsibility with the other, unconditionally, unperturbed by the other's behaviour, and am committed to facilitate

understanding in the other once the other is assured in relationship.

Q28. What are the consequences of disrespect?

Answer: Small incidents of disrespect can have long-lasting consequences — from not speaking to each other, to opposition, break in relationship, divorce, fights and even war. Disrespect arises from over-evaluation, under-evaluation or otherwise-evaluation, and also from differentiation leading to discrimination on the basis of body, physical facility or beliefs.

Respect — As the Right Evaluation

Q29. How is respect different from fear?

Answer: Respect is the **right evaluation** of the other — seeing the other as similar to me in purpose, programme and potential, and complementary in competence. Fear, on the other hand, arises from **domination and exploitation**: when there is wrong evaluation (over-evaluation, under-evaluation or otherwise-evaluation), the person feels disrespected, and the relationship gives way to fear and opposition. Fear is thus a symptom of disrespect and disharmony in relationship, while respect creates assurance and mutual trust — the basis of fearlessness in the family and society.

Other Values in Human-to-Human Relationship

Q30. Define 'affection' as a feeling in relationship.

Answer: Affection is the feeling of being related to the other — the feeling of acceptance for the other as one's relative. Lack of affection is seen in the form of opposition, jealousy, etc. The feelings of trust

and respect are essential to have the feeling of affection.

Q31. Define 'care' as a feeling in relationship.

Answer: Care is the feeling of responsibility and commitment for nurturing and protection of the Body of my relative. With the feeling of affection, one naturally takes responsibility for development of the

relative — both at the level of Self and Body. Being responsible to the Body of one's relative is Care.

Q32. Define 'guidance' as a feeling in relationship.

Answer: Guidance is the feeling of responsibility and commitment for development of the Self by ensuring the right understanding and right feeling in the Self of my relative. Being responsible to the Self of my relative is Guidance. Generally our focus is mostly on care because we assume human being =

Body and are not aware of the Self.

Q33. Define 'reverence' as a feeling in relationship.

Answer: Reverence is the feeling of acceptance for excellence. Excellence is to be in a state of continuous happiness with the completeness of understanding of harmony and living in harmony at all levels. Once achieved, excellence continues; it is definite and absolute. Worship is taking inspiration

from the revered and making effort for excellence.

Q34. What is the difference between working for excellence and competition?

Answer: If you have achieved excellence, you would naturally make effort for helping others to achieve excellence. On the other hand, in competition, we not only do not help rather we hinder the other from

reaching our level.

Q35. Define 'glory' as a feeling in relationship.

Answer: Glory is the feeling of acceptance for those who have made effort for excellence. For all those people whom we call great people, when we accept the effort made for excellence by them, to whatever

extent they are able to achieve it, we naturally have a feeling of glory for them.

Q36. Define 'gratitude' as a feeling in relationship.

Answer: Gratitude is the feeling of acceptance for those who have made the effort for my excellence. In our life, there may be many people who have been of help to us in the process of understanding

harmony and living in harmony. Gratitude is a significant feeling in the development of relationship.

Q37. Define 'love' as a feeling in relationship. Why is it called the 'complete value'?

Answer: Love is the feeling of being related to everyone, to all. It starts from affection; if this feeling expands to many and ultimately to all, it is the feeling of love. We begin with affection and complete it with love — that is why Love is called the complete value. Love is expressed in the form of compassion,

to whosoever comes in contact.

Q38. Distinguish between love and infatuation.

Answer: Love is not based on sensation. If a feeling is based on sensation, it is infatuation, where sensual pleasure becomes the major goal. Infatuation is conditional — it may last only as long as you get the sensation or have hope of getting happiness through sensation. It is very temporary; once the

effect wears off, the long-term issues of feelings become prominent.

Q39. Which has continuity — right feeling within myself or getting right feeling from the other?

Answer: There can be continuity of right feeling if it is from within and based on right understanding. Generally, we keep making effort for getting right feeling from the other in continuity, but this is not

sustainable.

Q40. What is the role of physical facility in the fulfilment of relationship?

Answer: Physical facility has a limited role. To fulfil the feeling of care, physical facility is certainly

required. For other feelings besides care, physical facility only has a symbolic role to play.

Q41. Distinguish between response and reaction in behaviour.

Answer: With response, your conduct is definite. With reaction, the conduct is indefinite. Understanding relationship, particularly trust on intention, gives clarity about the problems of living in reaction and the

possibility of living with response.

Q42. What is your participation (value) in the family?

Answer: My participation (value) vis-à-vis my family is to ensure harmony, mutual happiness and justice in the family by: (1) ensuring right feelings (trust, respect, affection, care, guidance, reverence, glory, gratitude and love) in myself — leading to my happiness; and (2) expressing (sharing) these feelings with the other. When the other rightly evaluates these feelings, it leads to mutual happiness. My participation is to be of help to the other in their self-evolution and self-development.

Understanding Harmony in the Society — Human Goal

Q43. What are the four elements of the comprehensive human goal?

Answer: The four elements are: (1) Right Understanding & Right Feeling (Happiness) — in every individual; (2) Prosperity — in every family; (3) Fearlessness (Trust) — in society; and (4) Co-Existence

(Mutual Fulfilment) — in nature/existence.

Q44. What is the appraisal of the current status of society?

Answer: Due to false assumptions (like 'money is everything'), happiness is sought through accumulation of physical facility by any means. Prosperity is seen as accumulating more and more. Instead of fearlessness (trust), we have domination, exploitation and fear. Instead of mutual fulfilment, we try to exploit and master nature. This has led to three obsessions and resource depletion, pollution,

terrorism and war.

Q45. What are the three kinds of obsessions prevalent in society today?

Answer: (1) Obsession for consumption, (2) Obsession for profit, and (3) Obsession for sensual

pleasure. These arise from the prevailing false assumptions about happiness and prosperity.

Q46. What is the correct sequence and priority order of the human goals?

Answer: The correct sequence is: (1) Right Understanding & Right Feeling (Happiness), (2) Prosperity, (3) Fearlessness (Trust), and (4) Co-Existence (Mutual Fulfilment). Right understanding comes first; the others follow from it.

Five Dimensions (Systems) of Human Order

Q47. Name the five basic systems (dimensions) of human order.

Answer: The five systems are: (1) Education-Sanskar, (2) Health-Self regulation, (3) Production-Work,

(4) Justice-Preservation, and (5) Exchange-Storage. They are interconnected and complementary.

Q48. Define 'education' and 'sanskar' in the context of the Education-Sanskar system.

Answer: Education is to develop right understanding of the harmony at all levels of being — from self to the entire existence (individual, family, society, and nature/existence). Sanskar is to develop the basic acceptances of the harmony at various levels. Education provides the commitment, preparation and

practice of living in harmony; our living is an expression of our sanskar.

Q49. Define 'self-regulation' and 'health' in the context of the Health-Self regulation system.

Answer: Self-regulation is the feeling of responsibility towards the Body, for nurturing, protection and right utilisation of the Body. Health of the Body is indicated by the fact that it is able to act according to

the instruction of the Self and the different parts of the Body are in harmony.

Q50. Define 'work' and 'production' in the context of the Production-Work system.

Answer: Work is the effort a human being does on the rest of nature, and Production is the physical facility obtained from work. The two important issues are: what to produce (physical facility required for

nurturing, protection and right utilisation of the Body) and how to produce.

Q51. What are the two criteria for 'how to produce'?

Answer: (1) The process needs to be cyclic and mutually enriching — it has to be eco-friendly. (2) Justice needs to be ensured in relationship with human beings — it has to be people-friendly. A production process is cyclic when the resources utilised return to their original state in due course of

their lifecycle.

Q52. What is 'resource depletion'? Give an example.

Answer: Resource depletion is the symptom of using a natural resource at a rate which is greater than the rate at which it is produced in nature. For example, if we use forest at a rate greater than the rate at

which it is produced in nature, there will be a shortage or depletion of forest.

Q53. What is 'pollution'? Give an example.

Answer: Pollution indicates that we are producing something which does not return to the cycle in nature, or it is produced at a rate faster than the rate at which it can return to the cycle in nature. For

example, plastic does not degrade; it does not return to the cycle of nature for many years.

Q54. Define 'justice' and 'preservation' in the context of the Justice-Preservation system.

Answer: Justice is recognition of human-human relationship, its fulfilment and evaluation leading to mutual happiness. Preservation is the recognition of relationship of human being with the rest of nature, its fulfilment and evaluation leading to mutual fulfilment. Preservation means enrichment, protection and

right utilisation of the rest of nature.

Q55. What should be done if someone does injustice?

Answer: (a) Stop the person from doing further injustice, as well as (b) help him/her to develop the competence for ensuring justice. In the present system, mostly we restrict ourselves to (a) and do not

do (b).

Q56. Define 'exchange' and 'storage' in the context of the Exchange-Storage system.

Answer: Exchange means sharing or exchanging physical facility with a view of mutual fulfilment and not with obsession for profit. Sharing is within the family; beyond that is exchange. Storage is preserving physical facility after fulfilment of needs, so that it is available when required — done with a view of

mutual fulfilment and not with obsession for accumulation or exploitation.

Q57. What is the scope of the societal systems?

Answer: The scope of the society is from family order to world family order. Every human being has a role in one or more of the social systems, starting from the family order, then the family cluster order, and so on to the nation family order and ultimately the world family order, leading to universal human order.

Vision for the Universal Human Order

Q58. What is 'family order' and what efforts does the family make?

Answer: Family order refers to the system in a family of responsible people living together for the common human goal. The family makes effort for: (1) mutual development of right understanding and right feeling in every member, including the next generation, leading to mutual happiness; (2)

participation in production of required physical facility in the form of labour, leading to prosperity; and (3)

contributing to a human society by participating at the next higher-level order.

Q59. What is 'family cluster order'?

Answer: Family cluster order is the next larger unit after family order. It is the system that a group of families evolve in order to fulfil those goals of individual families which require the participation of more people than the family has. The scope extends through successively larger units: Family Order → Family Cluster Order → Village Order → Village Cluster Order → ... → Nation Order → World Family

Order.

Q60. What is the natural outcome of right understanding?

Answer: (1) Happiness is ensured by having right understanding and right feeling in the Self. (2) Prosperity is a feeling of the availability of more than required physical facility; to ensure it, right understanding is required at the base, along with physical facility. (3) The tradition of living with happiness and prosperity starts from the family order and continuity can be ensured by the universal

human order.

Q61. What is your participation (value) in the society?

Answer: My participation (value) vis-à-vis society is to develop clarity of society, its goals, programme and scope, and play a part in the family order and then in the larger society. In the family order: ensuring happiness, health, and prosperity in the family, and facilitating members to participate in the larger society. In the larger society: playing a role in one or more dimensions of human order

(education-sanskar, health-self-regulation, production-work, justice-preservation, exchange-storage).

Q62. Define 'profession' in the context of a human society.

Answer: Profession is the participation of a human being in one or more of the dimensions of the societal systems. We may choose our participation where we have developed competence and interest. With the feeling of purpose and relatedness, our professions will be interrelated, and everyone is able to participate meaningfully for mutual fulfilment — including teachers, farmers, carpenters, doctors and so on.

SECTION B — Long/Descriptive Answer Questions (7 Marks Each)

Understanding Relationship, Justice and Harmony in the Family

Q1. Explain the four aspects of understanding relationship, and describe how harmony in the family is achieved through the fulfilment of these feelings.

Answer: The harmony in the family has primarily to do with the fulfilment of relationship between one human being and the other. To fulfil relationship, it is necessary to understand it. There are four important aspects of relationship:

1. Relationship is between one Self (In) and another Self (In): Relationship is already there — we do not have to construct or create it. We only need to understand and fulfil it. It is the Self which recognises the relationship, and not the Body. It is the Self which relates to the other, and not the Body.
2. There are feelings in relationship: The important issue in human relationship is that of feelings. Feelings are in the Self, not in the Body. It is the Self which has the feelings and which recognises them. To understand relationship, one has to understand the Self and the naturally acceptable feelings in the Self.
3. These feelings can be recognised — they are definite: There are nine feelings in relationship: Trust (foundation value), Respect, Affection, Care, Guidance, Reverence, Glory, Gratitude, and Love (complete value). These can be understood, ensured within ourselves, shared with others, and thus ensure mutual fulfilment.
4. Fulfilment of feelings and their right evaluation lead to mutual happiness: When we have these naturally acceptable feelings in the Self, we share them with the other. When we are both able to evaluate the feelings rightly, it leads to mutual happiness — the happiness of oneself as well as the happiness of the other. Harmony in the family is thus achieved by rightly recognising the relationship, identifying and ensuring the naturally acceptable feelings in ourselves, and sharing them with the other. This leads to mutual happiness, which is the essence of harmony in the family. The problem today is that we assume relationship on the basis of the Body rather than feelings, and try to make up the gap through physical facility or by demanding feelings from others. The way ahead is to ensure these feelings in ourselves first and then share them, leading to mutual happiness.

Trust — The Foundational Value in Relationship

Q2. Explain the feeling of trust as the foundational value in relationship, distinguishing between intention and competence, and describe the common mistake and wrong assumptions associated with trust.

Answer: Trust is to be assured that the other intends to make me happy and prosperous. It is the foundational feeling (value) in relationship — the beginning of mutual development. To understand trust, we examine eight statements divided into two categories: Intention (Natural Acceptance): (1a) I want to make myself happy. (2a) I want to make the other happy. (3a) The other wants to make himself/herself happy. (4a) The other wants to make me happy. By and large, there is a tick mark on 1a, 2a and 3a, and a question mark on 4a initially. Competence (Ability): (1b) I am able to make myself always happy. (2b) I am able to make the other always happy. (3b) The other is able to make himself/herself always happy. (4b) The other is able to make me always happy. There is a question mark on all of these — competence is generally lacking, and on 4b there is a big question mark. The key distinction is between intention and competence. Intention is what is naturally acceptable — the want. Competence is what one is — the ability. By and large, intention is positive (we all want happiness for ourselves and others), but competence is generally lacking (we are not always able to ensure it). The common mistake: We evaluate ourselves on the basis of our intention (and conclude that we are good), but we evaluate the other on the basis of their lack of competence (and conclude that the other wants to make us unhappy — doubting their intention). On the basis of lack of competence, we conclude about the lack of intention of the other. When we doubt their intention, instead of accepting the other as a relative, we have a feeling of opposition. Wrong assumptions: Since we do not see intention and competence separately,

and competence is generally lacking, the feeling of unconditional acceptance is almost completely missing. This reinforces wrong assumptions like: strangers can't be trusted; trust is developed over a long time; never trust anyone. If we can see intention and competence distinctly, we can place a tick mark in 4a — assured of the other's intention — and make a programme of interaction with right evaluation of our competence and their competence (so this is not 'blind' trust). If the other lacks competence, we try to improve it, which is a response indicating trust on intention; getting irritated, angry, or feeling opposition are reactions based on doubt on intention.

Respect — As the Right Evaluation

Q3. Explain respect as right evaluation, bringing out the minimum content, the complete content, and how differentiation leads to discrimination and disrespect.

Answer: Respect is right evaluation. When we are rightly evaluated, we feel respected. When we are not rightly evaluated, we feel disrespected. Disrespect can take place in three ways: over evaluation (evaluating for more than what it is), under evaluation (evaluating for less than what it is), and otherwise evaluation (evaluating for other than what it is). If any of these takes place, the other person feels uncomfortable and disrespected. Minimum Content of Respect — The Other is Similar to Me: When we evaluate the human being on the basis of the Self, we find: (1) Our purpose is the same — both have a natural acceptance to live with continuous happiness and prosperity. (2) Our programme is the same — both need to understand and live in harmony at all levels of being. (3) Our potential is the same — both are endowed with natural acceptance and the activities of desire, thought and expectation. Thus, the other (Self) is similar to me. This is the minimum content of respect. Disrespect through Differentiation Leading to Discrimination: In general, what we do in the name of respect today is differentiating and discriminating. There are three sets of differentiation: (1) On the basis of body — age, gender, race, physical strength. This is based on the gross misunderstanding that human being = Body. The truth is that human being = co-existence of the Self and the Body. (2) On the basis of physical facility — wealth and post. The misunderstanding is that physical facility = happiness. The truth is that happiness is to be in a state of harmony. (3) On the basis of beliefs — different isms, sects, and sets of information. The misunderstanding is that if the preconditioning of the other matches mine, the other is respectable. The truth is that preconditioning and right understanding are two different things. All this differentiation ultimately leads to discrimination, which is disrespect because it is not naturally acceptable. Complete Content of Respect — We are Complementary: At the level of the Self, only competence could be different. Competence means how much of the potential of the Self has been realised. This difference in competence is to be complementary to each other, not to discriminate and exploit. If the other has more understanding, I am committed to understand from the other. If I have more understanding, I live with responsibility with the other, unconditionally, unperturbed by the other's behaviour, and facilitate understanding in the other once assured in relationship. Thus, the complete content of respect is: the other is similar to me in terms of purpose, programme and potential, and we are complementary to each other in terms of competence. Small incidents of disrespect can have long-lasting consequences — from not speaking to each other to opposition, break in relationship, divorce, fights and even war.

Other Values in Human-to-Human Relationship

Q4. Explain the other naturally acceptable feelings in relationship (affection, care, guidance, reverence, glory, gratitude, love), distinguish between love and infatuation, and explain the role of physical facility, response vs. reaction, and your participation in the family.

Answer: Beyond trust and respect, there are seven other naturally acceptable feelings in relationship: Affection: The feeling of being related to the other — acceptance for the other as one's relative. Lack of affection is seen as opposition, jealousy, etc. Trust and respect are essential for affection. Care: The feeling of responsibility and commitment for nurturing and protection of the Body of my relative. With affection, one naturally takes responsibility for the development of the relative at both the level of Self and Body. Guidance: The feeling of responsibility and commitment for development of the Self by ensuring right understanding and right feeling in the Self of my relative. Generally, our focus is mostly

on care because we assume human being = Body and are not aware of the Self. Reverence: The feeling of acceptance for excellence. Excellence is to be in a state of continuous happiness with completeness of understanding of harmony and living in harmony at all levels. Worship is taking inspiration from the revered and making effort for excellence. Working for excellence means helping others achieve it; competition means hindering others. Glory: The feeling of acceptance for those who have made effort for excellence. When we accept the effort made by great people, we naturally have a feeling of glory for them. Gratitude: The feeling of acceptance for those who have made effort for my excellence. Many people have been of help in our process of understanding and living in harmony. Gratitude is a significant feeling in the development of relationship. Love: The feeling of being related to everyone, to all. It starts from affection and expands to all. That is why Love is called the complete value. It is expressed in the form of compassion. Love vs. Infatuation: Love is not based on sensation. Infatuation is based on sensation, where sensual pleasure becomes the major goal. Infatuation is conditional and temporary; it lasts only as long as the sensation or hope of happiness through sensation lasts. Once the effect wears off, long-term issues of feelings become prominent. Right Feeling: There can be continuity of right feeling only if it is from within and based on right understanding, not from the other. Role of Physical Facility: Physical facility has a limited role. For care, it is certainly required. For other feelings, it has only a symbolic role. Response vs. Reaction: With response, conduct is definite. With reaction, conduct is indefinite. Trust on intention enables response. My Participation (Value) in Family: To ensure harmony, mutual happiness and justice by ensuring right feelings in myself (leading to my happiness) and expressing them with the other (leading to mutual happiness), and being of help to the other in their self-evolution and self-development.

Harmony in the Society — Human Goal and Five Dimensions

Q5. Explain the comprehensive human goal, the appraisal of the current status, and the correct sequence of human goals. Also describe the five dimensions (systems) of human order in detail.

Answer: Comprehensive Human Goal: The goals of human being living in a society are: (1) Right Understanding & Right Feeling (Happiness) in every individual, (2) Prosperity in every family, (3) Fearlessness (Trust) in society, and (4) Co-Existence (Mutual Fulfilment) in nature/existence. Appraisal of Current Status: Due to false assumptions (like 'money is everything'), happiness is sought through accumulation of physical facility by any means, and prosperity is seen as accumulating more. This has led to three obsessions: obsession for consumption, obsession for profit, and obsession for sensual pleasure. Instead of fearlessness (trust), we have domination, exploitation and fear. Instead of mutual fulfilment, we exploit and try to master nature, leading to resource depletion, pollution, terrorism and war. The Way Ahead — Sequence: The correct sequence and priority order is: (1) Right Understanding & Right Feeling (Happiness), (2) Prosperity, (3) Fearlessness (Trust), (4) Co-Existence (Mutual Fulfilment). Right understanding comes first; the others follow from it. Five Dimensions (Systems) of Human Order:

1. Education-Sanskar: Education is to develop right understanding of harmony at all levels (individual, family, society, nature/existence). Sanskar is to develop the basic acceptances of harmony at various levels. Education provides commitment, preparation and practice of living in harmony. It leads to right understanding and right feeling (happiness).
2. Health-Self regulation: Self-regulation is the feeling of responsibility towards the Body for nurturing, protection and right utilisation. Health is indicated by the Body's ability to act according to the Self's instruction and the harmony of its parts. It leads to prosperity.
3. Production-Work: Work is the effort on the rest of nature; Production is the physical facility obtained. Two issues: what to produce (physical facility for nurturing, protection and right utilisation of the Body) and how to produce (cyclic and mutually enriching — eco-friendly; justice ensured — people-friendly). Resource depletion occurs when a resource is used faster than it is produced in nature; pollution occurs when something does not return to nature's cycle. It leads to prosperity.

4. Justice-Preservation: Justice is recognition, fulfilment and evaluation of human-human relationship leading to mutual happiness. If someone does injustice, we must stop them and help them develop competence. Preservation is recognition, fulfilment and evaluation of the human-nature relationship leading to mutual fulfilment — enrichment, protection and right utilisation of nature. Justice ensures fearlessness; preservation ensures co-existence.
5. Exchange-Storage: Exchange is sharing or exchanging physical facility with a view of mutual fulfilment, not obsession for profit. Storage is preserving physical facility after fulfilment of needs, for when required — not for accumulation or exploitation. It leads to prosperity and fearlessness. Scope: The scope is from family order to world family order, leading to universal human order.

Vision for the Universal Human Order

Q6. Explain the vision for the universal human order, describing the family order, family cluster order, the natural outcome of right understanding, your participation in society, and professions in a human society.

Answer: Harmony from Family Order to World Family Order — Universal Human Order: A society is composed of families living together with a common goal. Order in society starts with the family order — the smallest unit where all dimensions can take shape. Family order is the system in a family of responsible people living together for the common human goal. The family makes effort for: (1) mutual development of right understanding and right feeling in every member, including the next generation, leading to mutual happiness; (2) participation in production of required physical facility in the form of labour, leading to prosperity; and (3) contributing to a human society by participating at the next higher-level order. Family Cluster Order: The next larger unit. It is the system that a group of families evolve to fulfil goals that require more people than the family has. The scope extends through successively larger complementary units: Family Order → Family Cluster Order → Village Order → Village Cluster Order → ... → Nation Order → World Family Order. Natural Outcome of Right Understanding: (1) Happiness is ensured by right understanding and right feeling in the Self. (2) Prosperity is a feeling of availability of more than required physical facility; right understanding is required at the base, along with physical facility. (3) The tradition of living with happiness and prosperity starts from the family order and continuity can be ensured by the universal human order. My Participation (Value) in the Society: To develop clarity of society, its goals, programme and scope, and play a part in the family order and then in the larger society. In the family order: ensuring happiness (helping develop right understanding and right feeling in every member), health (system of nurturing, protection and right utilisation of the Body), and prosperity (helping the family recognise needs, production, protection and right utilisation of physical facility), and facilitating members to participate in the larger society. In the larger society: playing a role in one or more dimensions of human order (education-sanskar, health-self-regulation, production-work, justice-preservation, exchange-storage). Professions in a Human Society: Profession is the participation of a human being in one or more of the dimensions of the societal systems. We may choose our participation where we have developed competence and interest. With the feeling of purpose and relatedness, our professions will be interrelated, and everyone is able to participate meaningfully for mutual fulfilment — including teachers, farmers, carpenters, doctors and so on. The participation of every human being is required for the realisation of a universal human order, starting from the family order all the way to the world family order.

UNIT 4

SECTION A — Short Answer Questions (2 Marks Each)

Understanding Existence

Q1. What is meant by 'existence'?

Answer: Existence is everything that is — all material things, all living beings, and the space in which they exist, all functioning together as one interrelated whole. It is comprehensive, interconnected and self-organised — not a random collection of separate objects.

Q2. What is the partial (fragmented) view of nature?

Answer: The partial view sees nature as separate objects — rocks, trees, animals, humans — unrelated to each other; treats humans as separate from or superior to nature, free to exploit it; studies each thing in isolation (a tree, a river, a mineral) without seeing the relationship between them; and leads to fragmented, short-term decisions such as pollution, deforestation and resource depletion.

Q3. What is the comprehensive view of nature?

Answer: The comprehensive view sees nature as one interconnected, self-organised whole in which every part is related to every other part; understands the human being as an integral part of nature, participating in it rather than standing outside it; recognises four distinct orders (Material, Bio, Animal, Human), each with its own role, working together; and leads to harmony, sustainability and right participation — the basis for a value-based life.

Q4. Give two examples of the real consequences of the partial vs. comprehensive view.

Answer: (1) Deforestation for short-term profit — the partial view sees trees only as timber/land value, while the comprehensive view sees them sustaining soil, the water cycle, animal life and climate. (2) River pollution by industry — the partial view sees the river only as a waste-disposal channel, while the comprehensive view sees it as part of a living system supporting agriculture, drinking water and biodiversity. (Other valid examples: overuse of chemical fertilisers; species extinction.)

The Four Orders of Nature

Q5. Name the four orders of nature with their Hindi names.

Answer: (1) Material Order (Padarth Avastha), (2) Bio / Plant Order (Prana Avastha), (3) Animal Order (Jeevan Avastha), and (4) Human Order (Jeeva Avastha). All of existence can be comprehensively understood in terms of these four orders, each nested within and building upon the one before it. (In the teacher's manual, the material order is also called the physical order — the two terms mean the same.)

Q6. Describe the Material Order with examples.

Answer: The Material Order is matter that exists but does not grow or self-organise on its own — it has no capacity for self-organisation or growth, and obeys only physical and chemical laws. Examples: soil, water, air, minerals, rocks. It is the foundation on which all other orders depend.

Q7. Describe the Bio Order with examples.

Answer: The Bio Order has self-organisation in growth — the defining capability of plants. It draws on material-order elements (soil, water, air) to grow itself, and reproduces and sustains itself, but cannot move or sense the way animals do. Examples: trees, crops, flowers, algae. It directly sustains the animal and human orders above it.

Q8. Describe the Animal Order with examples.

Answer: The Animal Order has self-organisation in growth plus self-organisation in self-preservation. It has instinct, sense-perception and mobility, and acts to preserve itself — seeking food and avoiding danger. Its behaviour is governed by instinct, largely fixed by nature and not by choice. Examples: cattle, birds, fish, insects.

Q9. Describe the Human Order with examples.

Answer: The Human Order has self-organisation in growth, self-preservation, and self-evolution. It has reasoning, imagination and the ability to choose, and can improve its understanding and conduct over a lifetime. It is the only order that can consciously understand and choose to live in harmony with the rest of nature.

Q10. How is each higher order related to the ones below it?

Answer: Each higher order includes the properties of the ones below it and adds one capability of its own — a human being still has a material body and biological processes, plus self-awareness. Each order needs the order(s) below it and contributes to the order(s) above it: the material order provides the basis for the bio order, the bio order sustains the animal and human orders, and the human order can understand this whole and choose to nurture it (right participation).

Q11. What is an 'order' in nature?

Answer: An 'order' means a class of units sharing a common characteristic activity — the material order (units with physical existence only, no growth or self-repair: rocks, water, metals, air), the bio/plant order (units with growth, self-repair and reproduction but no free movement: trees, crops), the animal order (units that additionally have mobility, instinct and sensation), and the human order (units that additionally have self-awareness and choice). Understanding these four orders is the basis for understanding harmony in nature as a whole.

Q12. Explain the 'one tree, four orders' example.

Answer: In any tree, all four orders are visibly at work at the same time: the soil, water, minerals and air the tree draws on are the Material Order; the tree itself — growing, photosynthesising, reproducing via seeds — is the Bio Order; the birds nesting in it, insects pollinating it and squirrels feeding on it are the Animal Order; and the human being — resting in its shade, studying its biology, deciding whether to protect or cut it — is the Human Order. A partial view sees only 'a tree'; a comprehensive view sees an entire self-organised system in harmony.

Nature as Units and Space

Q13. What is meant by nature as a collection of units?

Answer: Nature is the collection of all the units — the air, soil, water, plants, trees, animals, birds, other human beings, and even things that are at a distance from us like the sun, the moon and the other planets. Although the units are innumerable, they can all be classified into just four orders: physical/material (air, water, metal), bio (grass, plants, trees), animal (animals and birds), and human (human beings). Each unit can be understood in terms of its constitution, its participation with other units, and its innateness. All the units are related to one another and co-exist in harmony.

Q14. State the sequence of abundance among the four orders of nature.

Answer: The Material Order is the most abundant (soil, water and air are available in the largest quantity), followed by the Bio Order (plants), then the Animal Order, and the Human Order is the least abundant. As we move up the orders, abundance decreases — like a pyramid, with the material order at the base. The lower orders serve the higher ones, so there is naturally more of what is needed at the base: material → bio → animal → human.

Q15. Differentiate between units and space in terms of size and activity.

Answer: **Size:** every unit is limited in size — big or small, from an atom to the largest star — whereas space has no size; it is all-pervading and unlimited. **Activity:** every unit is active — engaged in a definite, continuous activity (an electron revolves, a plant grows, an animal moves) — whereas space is not active; it does not do anything, does not interact with anything, and is not affected by anything. Space simply accommodates all the units.

Q16. What is self-regulation in nature? Give one example.

Answer: Self-regulation in nature means the four orders inherently maintain harmony and balance among themselves without any external control — each unit takes only as much as it needs, and the

cycles of nature (water cycle, food chains, nutrient cycles) run automatically. **Example:** in a forest, the proportion of soil, plants and animals of various species is self-regulated — it never happens that the lions eat up all the deer, or the deer eat up all the grasses, or that plants grow to the extent that there is no space for the deer or lack of soil for new plants. The forest does not need to be regulated by human beings to be in harmony.

Q17. What is meant by 'existence is co-existence'?

Answer: Existence is the co-existence of all units in space — units related to one another in mutual fulfilment. Every unit, from an atom to a human being, is connected to and depends on other units; nothing exists in isolation. There is no conflict in existence at the level of nature — the four orders are inherently in harmony. To be in existence is to co-exist: I exist along with, and in relationship with, everything else.

Q18. What is meant by 'submergence'? State its three implications.

Answer: Units are in space — they are submerged in space. It means units are in space and are inseparable from space; wherever a unit is, space is also there. Submergence implies three things: (1) **Units are energised in space** — being in co-existence with space, every unit is energised, right from the smallest atom to the largest planet. (2) **Units are self-organised in space** — every unit is in a definite order, and by being in a definite order it exhibits a definite conduct; that is how one can identify, recognise and study a unit. (3) **Units recognise their relationship and fulfil it** with every other unit in space.

Q19. Units are of two types. Name them and differentiate between them.

Answer: Units are of two types — material units and consciousness units. **Material units** are temporary in time, while **consciousness units (the Self)** are continuous. Material units recognise and fulfil their relationship with other units — their conduct is definite. Consciousness units (in the animal and human orders) recognise and fulfil their relationship on the basis of assuming without knowing or assuming based on knowing — the conduct is definite if it operates on the basis of assuming based on knowing, and indefinite if it operates on the basis of assuming without knowing.

Q20. How are material units composed? Describe the hierarchy.

Answer: All material units are composed of other (simpler) material units. The smallest or fundamental stable material unit is the atom. An atom may combine with another atom to form a molecule; molecules further combine to form molecular structures; and molecular structures can exist either as lumps or as fluids. Fluids provide the nurturing of cells, and such cells combine to form plants, the animal body and the human body. (The animal order is the co-existence of the consciousness/Self and the animal body; the human order is the co-existence of the consciousness/Self and the human body.)

Mutual Fulfilment in Nature

Q21. What is meant by mutual fulfilment among the four orders of nature?

Answer: Each order is fulfilling for the others in a continuous cycle: the soil (material order) provides minerals and water; plants (bio order) grow using soil, air and sunlight; animals and humans eat plants and breathe oxygen; and waste and remains return nutrients to the soil — so the cycle continues. Nothing is wasted and nothing stands alone; the fulfilment flows in both directions between the orders.

Q22. Explain the role of animals and birds in the mutual fulfilment of the bio order.

Answer: Animals and birds help the bio order in three main ways: (1) **Pollination** — bees, butterflies and birds carry pollen from flower to flower, enabling plants to reproduce (the honeybee collects nectar for itself while pollinating the flower in return). (2) **Seed dispersal** — birds eat fruits and disperse the seeds over a wide area, helping new plants grow. (3) **Manure** — animal waste returns nutrients to the soil, enriching it for plants. In return, plants provide animals and birds with food, shelter and oxygen.

Q23. 'Harmony does not mean sameness.' Explain.

Answer: Harmony in nature does not mean that all orders are the same — each distinct order has its own characteristic activity and plays its part in a way that supports and completes the others. The material, bio, animal and human orders are different, but their differences are complementary. Disturbing one order significantly (e.g., destroying soil health or forests) affects the fulfilment of every other order, including the human order.

Q24. What is the present state of the human order vis-à-vis the other three orders? What is the desired state?

Answer: Present state: there is mutual fulfilment among the first three orders — the soil-plant interaction is an example of mutual fulfilment between the physical order and the bio order; animals and birds depend on plants for food and, in turn, help spread seeds and protect plants from harmful insects and pests; air and water are essential for animals; and animals enrich the soil (their dung and dead bodies act as very good manure). The first three orders are enriching for the human being too. However, the human being is not only unfulfilling for the other three orders — rather, it is dominating and exploiting them, to the extent of global warming and climate change. **Desired state:** our natural acceptance is to enrich all the four orders; once human beings understand the mutual fulfilment among the four orders, they can be fulfilling for all the orders.

The Four Orders in Detail — Activity, Innateness, Natural Characteristic and Inheritance

Q25. Name and define the four parameters on the basis of which the four orders can be studied.

Answer: (1) **Activity** — the internal activity in the unit, based on its self-organisation. (2) **Innateness** — the definite self-organisation of a unit; by virtue of its definite self-organisation, the unit exhibits a definite conduct/property. The unit is also self-regulated, and a unit and its innateness are inseparable. (3) **Natural characteristic** — the natural participation of a unit in the larger order. (4) **Inheritance** — the way by which the units ensure the continuity of their definite conduct, generation after generation.

Q26. Describe the activity and innateness of the four orders.

Answer: Activity: Physical order (soil, metal) — formation–deformation (composition–decomposition). Bio order (plants, trees) — the same, plus respiration. Animal order (animals, birds) — the same, plus activity in the body, plus selecting–tasting in the Self. Human order — the same, plus activity in the body, plus imaging, analysing–comparing and selecting–tasting in the Self, and the potential for contemplation, understanding and realisation in the Self.

Innateness: Physical order — existence. Bio order — existence plus growth. Animal order — the same in the body, plus the will to live in the Self. Human order — the same in the body, plus the will to live with continuous happiness in the Self, and right feeling and right thought in the Self.

Q27. Describe the natural characteristic and inheritance of the four orders.

Answer: Natural characteristic: Physical order — composition-based. Bio order — the same, plus nurture/worsen; seed-based. Animal order — the same in the body, plus cruelty or non-cruelty in the Self. Human order — the same in the body, plus perseverance, bravery, generosity and right understanding in the Self.

Inheritance: Physical order — constitution-based. Bio order — seed-based. Animal order — breed-based. Human order — education-sanskar. All orders, except the human order, exhibit definite conduct through their inheritance; in order to ensure definite human conduct, human education-sanskar is required.

Q28. 'All orders in nature exhibit definite conduct except the human order.' Explain.

Answer: By virtue of their definite self-organisation (innateness), the units of the physical, bio and animal orders exhibit definite conduct, generation after generation, through their inheritance (constitution-based, seed-based and breed-based respectively). The human order, however, does not automatically exhibit definite conduct: the Self of the human being operating on the basis of assuming

without knowing is the source of indefiniteness and the problems thereof. The solution is to ensure knowing — with knowing, with right understanding, human beings can also have definite conduct. For this, human education-sanskar is required.

The Need and Process of Inner Evolution

Q29. Why is knowing something intellectually not enough?

Answer: Most of us know in principle that honesty is good or that nature should be respected, yet our actual living often does not match — we still copy in exams under pressure, litter or waste water casually, and chase possessions over people. The gap exists because information is not the same as realization: we may have heard or read the right thing, but we have not explored and verified it within ourselves, so it stays as borrowed information rather than our own understanding. That verification is what inner evolution provides.

Q30. What is inner evolution?

Answer: Inner evolution is the process by which a human being moves from borrowed beliefs and assumptions to a self-verified, natural understanding of what is right — and then naturally lives accordingly. It is natural, not forced (like physical growth, understanding can naturally deepen); it happens through exploration, not instruction (you verify things through your own natural acceptance); it is universal (the same process works for every human being); and it leads to consistent living — no gap between knowing and doing.

Q31. Name the three steps of the process of inner evolution.

Answer: (1) **Self-Exploration** — a dialogue within yourself, questioning and examining what you assume to be true, using your own natural acceptance as the check. (2) **Self-Awareness** — becoming clearly aware of the difference between what you truly are (the Self) and the physical body, and their distinct needs. (3) **Self-Evaluation** — honestly assessing your own thoughts, feelings and actions against what you have understood, and correcting the gap. It is a continuous, deepening cycle, not a one-time event.

Q32. What is self-exploration? Give an example.

Answer: Self-exploration is a dialogue within yourself — examining the beliefs, values and assumptions you have accepted from parents, teachers, media or society, and checking whether they are naturally acceptable to you. It works by asking yourself 'why' about what you believe instead of accepting it automatically, comparing it against your natural acceptance (what feels right on reflection, not just what is convenient), and noticing the difference between 'I was told this' and 'I have verified this for myself'.

Example: you were taught 'more money means more happiness' — self-exploration means pausing to ask whether more money has actually made the wealthiest people you know happier, or whether something else is at play.

Q33. What is self-awareness? Give an example.

Answer: Self-awareness is becoming clearly aware that 'I' (the conscious Self) am different from 'my body' — and that each has distinct needs: the Self wants happiness and prosperity, while the body wants comfort and physical facility. It means recognising the Self as the 'seer, feeler and doer' — the one who is aware — distinct from the body it uses as an instrument, which helps you identify whose need you are actually fulfilling in a given choice. **Example:** you skip studying to watch one more video, telling yourself 'I'll feel good' — self-awareness asks whether this is fulfilling the Self (real, lasting satisfaction) or only the body's momentary comfort.

Q34. What is self-evaluation? Give an example.

Answer: Self-evaluation is honestly checking your own thoughts, feelings and actions against your now-verified understanding — and consciously working to close any gap you find. It works by asking, at the end of a day or decision, whether your behaviour matched what you understand to be right; by being honest rather than self-defensive; and by identifying one specific, small correction rather than a vague

resolution to 'be better'. **Example:** you value honesty but exaggerated a story to impress friends — self-evaluation means noticing this gap honestly and choosing the next opportunity to speak more truthfully.

Q35. Why is inner evolution a continuous, deepening cycle?

Answer: The three steps feed into each other, again and again: exploring a belief (exploration) sharpens your sense of Self vs. body (awareness); that clarity gives you a standard to check your actions against (evaluation); and what you discover in evaluation raises new questions — sending you back to explore further. Each round deepens your understanding over time; the three steps are not a one-time checklist.

Q36. State any two misconceptions about self-exploration.

Answer: (1) Self-exploration is NOT blindly accepting what elders, teachers or media say — it is questioning it and checking it against your own natural acceptance. (2) It is NOT rejecting everything just to be different or rebellious — it is openly examining ideas; some will be verified as true and some won't. (3) It is NOT following only what feels good in the moment — it checks what brings lasting, real satisfaction at the level of the Self, not the body. (4) It is NOT a one-time decision — it is an ongoing dialogue you return to as you grow.

Activities of the Self — Realization, Understanding, Contemplation

Q37. Name the three activities of the Self awakened through inner evolution.

Answer: (1) **Understanding** — clarity in the intellect about 'what is true', a conceptual, verbal grasp that you can explain in words. (2) **Realization** — the same truth becoming your own direct experience, felt within the Self, beyond words. (3) **Contemplation** — sustained reflection connecting what is understood and realized to your own living and participation. Together they lead to a comprehensive, livable knowledge of existence.

Q38. Differentiate between understanding and realization, with the sugar example.

Answer: **Understanding** is reading that sugar is sweet — you can define sweetness, describe its chemistry and quote what others have said, entirely in words and concepts; it happens in the intellect. **Realization** is actually tasting the sugar — the sweetness becomes your own direct experience; no words are required and no one can argue you out of it once tasted; it happens in the Self. A student can 'understand' that honesty is important and score full marks explaining why — yet still copy in an exam; realization is when honesty is felt as one's own value.

Q39. What is contemplation? Explain with the gravity example.

Answer: Contemplation is sustained, deliberate reflection connecting what is understood and realized to one's own living and participation — asking: 'Given what I understand and have realized, what does this mean for how I act and participate?' **Example:** you understand gravity as a force of mutual attraction and can state Newton's law (understanding); you feel your own weight, feel a fall, feel the pull — it is no longer just a formula (realization); and you contemplate — you secure loose objects at height, design stairs with railings, and walk carefully near edges. Contemplation shapes actual conduct.

Q40. What is meant by 'realization of co-existence'?

Answer: It is recognizing directly — not merely as an intellectual idea — that 'I' and 'Nature' are not separate: my existence is already interconnected with the material, bio and human orders around me. It can be directly realized by observing one's own life closely: tracing everything that had to exist for you to be sitting where you are — the air you breathe, the food you ate, the people who built the room, your parents — and noticing that not one of these is truly separate from you.

Q41. Give examples of co-existence at three scales of everyday life.

Answer: (1) **Physical scale** — a tree cannot exist without soil, water, sunlight and air, and in turn releases the oxygen that sustains animal and human life. (2) **Family/social scale** — an individual exists only in relationship, as someone's child, sibling, friend or student; remove all the relationships and 'who

I am' becomes unclear. (3) **Societal scale** — a farmer, teacher, doctor or engineer is not self-sufficient; society exists because each person's competence fulfils a need for everyone else. At every scale, existence works because units are mutually fulfilling, not competing to survive alone.

Q42. Distinguish between the fragmented view and the holistic view.

Answer: Fragmented view (before): nature is a resource to use up; 'me' vs. 'the environment' as separate; success means my gain regardless of the cost to others; ethics is an external rule imposed on me. **Holistic view (after):** nature is a web I am already part of; 'me' and 'existence' are in continuous co-existence; success includes the fulfilment of the whole I am part of; ethics arises naturally from realized understanding.

The Human Order's Unique Role and Responsibility

Q43. What is a human being in terms of the Self and the Body?

Answer: A human being is the co-existence of the Self (Jeevan — the conscious 'I') and the Body (Sharir — the material-biological unit). The Self is the conscious entity that understands, feels and chooses; the Body is the material instrument used by the Self. It is the Self which relates, decides and experiences; the Body acts on its instruction.

Q44. What is the human order's unique responsibility in nature?

Answer: Only the human order can ask 'why?' — a plant grows and an animal acts by disposition, but only a human being can question, evaluate and choose whether an action is right. Because we alone can understand harmony, we alone are responsible for preserving or disturbing it — the other orders participate automatically, while we participate consciously. Every professional decision — engineer, teacher, doctor — is a choice about sustaining or disrupting this harmony.

Q45. 'Harmony is a fact; participating in it is a choice.' Explain.

Answer: The material, plant and animal orders act spontaneously — they are automatically in harmony; a river does not choose to flow, a tree does not choose to grow towards light, and they cannot act otherwise, so there is no question of contradiction for them. The human order has consciousness (the ability to know self and existence) and choice (the freedom to select our actions) — so harmony for us is not automatic; it must be understood, willed and lived. Participation means choosing to act in line with the harmony that already exists.

Q46. What is the significance of education-sanskar for the human order?

Answer: The material, bio and animal orders are naturally in harmony by their innateness (self-regulation) — they need no teaching. The human order, having choice (the conscious Self with desire, thought and expectation), can either participate in harmony or be in contradiction. Therefore the human order needs education-sanskar: education to develop right understanding of harmony at all levels (self, family, society, nature/existence), and sanskar to develop the basic acceptances of living accordingly. With education-sanskar, humans can fulfil their unique role — enrichment, protection and right utilisation of nature — instead of exploiting it.

Q47. How does the cycle of education-sanskar continue generation after generation?

Answer: Through human education and sanskar, we can ensure right understanding in us; this, in turn, ensures the right feeling in us. With right understanding and right feeling in the Self, we are able to ensure the continuity of harmony and happiness in ourselves and live accordingly. Then, we can be a source of human education-sanskar for the next generation. Once this cycle is complete, it can continue generation after generation.

Q48. Describe the dependence of the human being on the other three orders.

Answer: The physical order can exist and sustain itself without any support from the other orders. The units of the bio order, however, are dependent on the units of the physical order for their existence. The units of the animal order, besides being dependent on the air and water of the physical order for their survival, are also dependent on the bio order for their food. The human order is dependent on all the

other three orders for its existence and survival. If the human being does not ensure a relationship of mutual fulfilment with the other three orders, the human being is certainly going to face the negative consequences.

Q49. What is the mutually fulfilling interaction of the human order in nature?

Answer: The role of the human being when interacting with other human beings as well as with the rest of nature is: (1) facilitate a conducive environment for the activities of all the four orders in nature (or at least not violate them); (2) facilitate the innateness of all the four orders in nature (or at least not violate it); (3) participate with its natural characteristic and facilitate the natural characteristic of all the four orders in nature (or at least not violate it); and (4) ensure the inheritance of all the four orders of nature (or at least not violate it).

Q50. What is meant by right utilisation, enrichment and protection of nature?

Answer: These are the three aspects of the human order's participation in nature: **Protection** — safeguarding the continuity of nature (e.g., preventing deforestation, soil erosion, pollution of rivers). **Enrichment** — improving the quantity and quality of nature (e.g., planting trees, water harvesting, composting). **Right utilisation** — using natural resources according to real need, in limited quantity, for nurturing, protecting and rightly utilising the body — not hoarding or wasting (using only as much water, food or electricity as is needed). While interacting with any unit of nature, our participation (value) is ensuring mutual fulfilment by way of its right utilisation in accordance with its natural characteristic, so that it can continue with its innateness and inheritance — this results in prosperity for the human being and preservation (protection and enrichment) of the rest of nature.

Human Participation in Harmony

Q51. Name the four kinds of human participation in harmony.

Answer: (1) **With the Self** — keeping body and self in harmony: sleep, discipline, honest self-evaluation instead of distraction or self-neglect. (2) **With the family / society** — right relationship: trust, respect and affection in the family; contributing to society rather than only taking from it. (3) **With nature** — using material and biological resources responsibly: not wasting water, food or electricity. (4) **With existence as a whole** — recognising that every choice ripples outward, and each small daily habit either supports or disturbs the larger balance.

Q52. Give two examples each of contradiction and participation in daily life.

Answer: Contradiction: leaving taps running / wasting water — vs. participation: using only what is needed, fixing leaks. Contradiction: littering the classroom or campus — vs. participation: disposing of waste responsibly, segregating it. Contradiction: ignoring family to stay on the phone — vs. participation: giving undivided time and attention at home. Contradiction: competing to put others down — vs. participation: competing while respecting and helping peers.

Q53. What is comprehensive knowledge about existence?

Answer: Comprehensive knowledge is seeing all four orders together with one's own responsible place among them. Existence is the co-existence of the four orders — Material, Bio/Plant, Animal and Human — related to one another in space, in a mutually fulfilling, interconnected, self-regulating, recyclable relationship, with the human being, once aware, willingly participating in and upholding that harmony. In short: four orders, one existence, your choice.

Q54. Why does the comprehensive understanding of existence matter?

Answer: (1) **Sustainability** — it guides responsible use of natural resources (water, energy, materials) instead of exploitative use. (2) **Family and social harmony** — it grounds trust, respect and cooperation in relationships at home, in hostel life and among peers. (3) **Personal well-being** — a person acting in contradiction with self and others lives in constant unease, while participation brings inner ease. (4) **Bridge to professional ethics** — one who can act in harmony personally can extend the same to one's future profession (Module 5).

Illustrations from Everyday Life

Q55. Explain the honeybee and flower example.

Answer: The bee collects nectar for itself (its own need) while pollinating the flower in the process — the animal order fulfils the plant order without either being harmed. It shows that nature's orders participate in mutual fulfilment automatically: self-interest and the other's fulfilment are not in conflict in nature.

Q56. How does the human body show all four orders in one?

Answer: The body's atoms follow the material order; its cells grow and heal like the bio/plant order; its organs function like the animal order; and only you — the human order — can be aware of all this and choose. The human body is thus a living example of the co-existence of all four orders.

Q57. Explain the crop rotation vs. over-farming example.

Answer: A farmer who rotates crops and lets the soil recover is deliberately participating in nature's self-organising capacity (enrichment and protection of the material and bio orders). A farmer who repeatedly over-extracts from the same land is in contradiction with it — even though the harm (soil degradation) shows up only years later. The example shows the difference between participation and contradiction in the human order's relationship with nature.

Q58. Explain the shared family meal example.

Answer: An ordinary daily meal cooked and eaten together — everyone contributing, no one served last or left out — is trust, respect and relationship in practice. It shows the same harmony logic scaled up from the self to the family and society: mutual fulfilment at the level of relationship.

The Holistic Perception of Harmony in Existence

Q59. What is development in the existential sense? Where is it possible?

Answer: Whatever we do with the material world is cyclic — it will keep changing and keep going back to its initial state, no matter what we do; in that sense, there is no development in the material world. Only in the human order is there a potential for development or transformation in the Self, which is not cyclic — development or permanent change is possible only in the domain of consciousness. This development is in terms of: (1) developing right understanding (understanding co-existence) and right feeling (feeling of co-existence) in the Self — awakening to the activities of realisation (of co-existence), understanding (of self-organisation, harmony) and contemplation (of relationship, participation in the larger order); and (2) living on the basis of right understanding and right feeling — updating all our desires, thoughts and expectations in line with it, and expressing it in the form of behaviour, work and participation in the larger order. This development is facilitated by education-sanskara; there is every provision in existence for this development.

Q60. How is co-existence expressed at different levels?

Answer: All that we discussed about harmony at the level of the individual, family, society and nature is basically the systematic reflection (the expression) of existence as co-existence: (1a) **Self (I)** — continuous happiness (happiness, peace, satisfaction, bliss) through realisation of co-existence → feeling and thought of co-existence → co-existential behaviour, work and participation; (1b) **Individual human being** — co-existence of the Self (I) and the Body; (2) **Family** — feeling of co-existence, trust, respect... love and justice, leading to an undivided society; (3) **Society** — right understanding and right feeling, prosperity, fearlessness (trust) and co-existence, through the human-human relationship, natural laws and the universal human order (human tradition); (4a) **Nature** — mutual fulfilment among the four orders; and (4b) **Existence** — co-existence, in the form of units submerged in space (energised, self-organised, recognising and fulfilling relationship).

Q61. What is the role of the human being in existence?

Answer: The human being has a definite participation in existence — it is to complete the process of development through itself. All that the human being needs to do is to understand the co-existence and

to live in co-existence. Understanding co-existence means the Self awakening to the activities of realisation, understanding and contemplation; this clarity guides our desires and thus all the activities of imagination (desire, thought and expectation). The right feeling and right thought so formed become the basis of our behaviour with other human beings, our work with the rest of nature, and our participation in the larger order. The expansion of such behaviour from family to world family leads to an undivided society; work based on natural laws with the rest of nature results in mutual prosperity; and participation in the larger order results in the fulfilment of the human goal. The expansion of such work and participation, from family order to world family order, leads to the universal human order.

From the Reference Readings

Q62. What does E. F. Schumacher argue in 'Small is Beautiful' (1973)?

Answer: Schumacher argues that economics built on ever-larger scale and unlimited resource use loses sight of human-scale, sustainable living — ignoring mutual fulfilment with the material and bio orders. The book illustrates the consequences of a partial, exploitative view of nature.

Q63. What does Ivan Illich argue in 'Energy and Equity' (1974)?

Answer: Illich shows that, past a point, more energy consumption creates inequity rather than progress — a caution about over-drawing on the material order without balance.

Q64. What does Susan George examine in 'How the Other Half Dies' (1976)?

Answer: She examines how food scarcity is often not about nature's limits but about unequal, non-fulfilling participation among human beings — harmony broken within the human order itself.

SECTION B — Long/Descriptive Answer Questions (7 Marks Each)

The Four Orders of Nature

Q1. Explain the four orders of nature in detail, showing how each higher order includes the capabilities of the ones below it. Illustrate with the 'one tree' example.

Answer: All of existence can be comprehensively understood in terms of four orders, each nested within and building upon the one before it:

1. Material Order (Padarth Avastha): Matter that exists but does not grow or self-organise on its own. It obeys only physical and chemical laws and has no capacity for self-organisation or growth. Examples: soil, water, air, minerals, rocks. It is the foundation on which all other orders depend.

2. Bio Order (Prana Avastha): Adds self-organisation in growth — the defining capability of plants. It draws on material-order elements (soil, water, air) to grow itself, and reproduces and sustains itself, but cannot move or sense the way animals do. Examples: trees, crops, flowers, algae. It directly sustains the animal and human orders above it.

3. Animal Order (Jeevan Avastha): Adds self-organisation in self-preservation. Animals have instinct, sense-perception and mobility; they act to preserve themselves — seeking food and avoiding danger. Their behaviour is governed by instinct, largely fixed by nature, not choice. Examples: cattle, birds, fish, insects.

4. Human Order (Jeeva Avastha): Adds self-evolution — humans have reasoning, imagination and the ability to choose, and can improve their understanding and conduct over a lifetime. It is the only order that can consciously understand and choose to live in harmony with the rest of nature.

Each higher order includes the lower ones: a human being still has a material body and biological processes, plus self-awareness. Each order needs the orders below it and contributes to the orders above it: material provides the basis for bio, bio sustains animal and human, and the human order can understand the whole and choose to nurture it (right participation).

The one tree example: in any tree, all four orders are visibly at work at the same time — the soil, water, minerals and air it draws on (Material Order); the tree itself, growing, photosynthesising, reproducing via seeds (Bio Order); the birds nesting, insects pollinating, squirrels feeding on it (Animal Order); and the human being, resting in its shade, studying it, deciding whether to protect or cut it (Human Order). A partial view sees only 'a tree'; a comprehensive view sees an entire self-organised system in harmony.

The Need and Process of Inner Evolution

Q2. What is inner evolution? Explain its need and its three-step process (self-exploration, self-awareness, self-evaluation) with examples, and clarify the common misconceptions about self-exploration.

Answer: The need: most of us already know, in principle, that honesty is good or that nature should be respected, yet our actual living often does not match what we know — we still copy in exams under pressure, litter or waste water casually, and chase possessions over people. This gap exists because information is not the same as realization: we have heard or read the right thing, but we have not explored and verified it within ourselves, so it stays as borrowed information, not our own understanding.

Inner evolution is the process by which a human being moves from borrowed beliefs and assumptions to a self-verified, natural understanding of what is right — and then naturally lives accordingly. It is

natural (not forced), happens through exploration (not instruction), is universal (available to every human being), and leads to consistent living — no gap between knowing and doing.

Step 1 — Self-Exploration: a dialogue within yourself, examining the beliefs, values and assumptions accepted from parents, teachers, media or society, and checking whether they are naturally acceptable to you. Ask 'why' about what you believe instead of accepting it automatically; notice the difference between 'I was told this' and 'I have verified this for myself'. Example: you were taught 'more money means more happiness' — self-exploration means pausing to ask whether more money has actually made the wealthiest people you know happier.

Step 2 — Self-Awareness: becoming clearly aware that 'I' (the conscious Self) am different from 'my body', and that each has distinct needs — the Self wants happiness and prosperity, the body wants comfort and physical facility. Recognise the Self as the 'seer, feeler and doer', distinct from the body it uses as an instrument. Example: skipping study to watch one more video — self-awareness asks whether this fulfils the Self's lasting satisfaction or only the body's momentary comfort.

Step 3 — Self-Evaluation: honestly checking your own thoughts, feelings and actions against your now-verified understanding, and consciously working to close the gap — being honest rather than self-defensive, and identifying one specific, small correction rather than a vague resolution. Example: you value honesty but exaggerated a story to impress friends — evaluation means noticing the gap honestly and choosing the next opportunity to speak more truthfully.

It is a continuous, deepening cycle: exploring a belief sharpens your sense of Self vs. body; that clarity gives a standard to check your actions against; and what evaluation reveals sends you back to explore further. Worked example (group project dilemma): a teammate who hasn't contributed agrees to have his name included — exploration questions the assumption that submitting on time matters more than fairness; awareness sees that going along keeps the body comfortable but does not sit right with the Self; evaluation decides to talk to the teammate honestly before submission.

Misconceptions: self-exploration is NOT blindly accepting what elders, teachers or media say (it is questioning and checking against your own natural acceptance); it is NOT rejecting everything just to be rebellious (it is openly examining ideas — some will be verified as true, some won't); it is NOT following only what feels good in the moment (it checks for lasting, Self-level satisfaction); and it is NOT a one-time decision (it is an ongoing dialogue).

Realization, Understanding and Contemplation in the Self

Q3. Explain the three activities of the Self — Understanding, Realization and Contemplation — with suitable examples, and show how together they lead to comprehensive knowledge of existence.

Answer: Right understanding does not stay in the head — it moves through three stages:

1. Understanding: clarity in the intellect about 'what is true' — a conceptual, verbal grasp that you can explain in words. It happens in the intellect.

2. Realization: the same truth becomes your own direct experience, felt within the Self — beyond words. **Example (sugar):** reading that sugar is sweet — defining sweetness, describing its chemistry — is understanding; actually tasting the sugar, so that the sweetness becomes your own direct experience which no one can argue you out of, is realization. A student can 'understand' that honesty is important and score full marks explaining why, yet still copy in an exam; realization is when honesty is felt as one's own value.

3. Contemplation: sustained, deliberate reflection connecting what is understood and realized to your

own living and participation — asking: 'Given what I understand and have realized, what does this mean for how I act?' **Example (gravity):** you understand gravity as a law of mutual attraction (understanding); you feel your own weight and the pull of a fall, so it is no longer just a formula (realization); and you contemplate — you secure loose objects at height, design stairs with railings, walk carefully near edges — which shapes actual conduct.

Applied to existence: (1) **Realization of Co-Existence** — recognizing directly that 'I' and 'Nature' are not separate: my existence is already interconnected with the material, bio and human orders around me; it can be realized by tracing everything that had to exist for me to be here right now — air, food, people, parents — none of which is truly separate from me. (2) **Understanding of Harmony in Nature** — grasping how the four orders relate: each order fulfils the one below and is fulfilled by the one above, a chain of mutual fulfilment, not isolated survival. (3) **Contemplation of Participation** — reflecting on how 'I', as a human being with awareness and choice, actually take part in and carry forward this harmony: do my daily choices support or strain the balance between the orders? In my relationships, am I a fulfilling part of the whole? Will my professional work add to harmony or disturb it?

Together: understanding + realization + contemplation produce a comprehensive, livable knowledge of existence. The fragmented view (nature as a resource to use up; 'me' vs. 'the environment'; ethics as an external rule) gives way to the holistic view (nature as a web I am already part of; success including the fulfilment of the whole; ethics arising naturally from realized understanding).

Existence as Co-Existence and Mutual Fulfilment

Q4. Explain 'existence is co-existence' and mutual fulfilment among the four orders of nature.

Bring out the role of animals and birds in the bio order's fulfilment, self-regulation in nature, and the difference between units and space.

Answer: Existence is co-existence: existence is the co-existence of all units in space, related to one another in mutual fulfilment. Every unit — from an atom to a human being — is connected to and depends on other units; nothing exists in isolation. This shows up at every scale: physically, a tree cannot exist without soil, water, sunlight and air, and in turn releases the oxygen that sustains animal and human life; socially, an individual exists only in relationship (as someone's child, sibling, friend, student); societally, a farmer, teacher, doctor or engineer is not self-sufficient — society exists because each person's competence fulfils a need for everyone else. Nature is thus a collection of units — material, bio, animal and human — each understandable in terms of its constitution, its participation with other units, and its innateness.

Mutual fulfilment among the four orders: each order is fulfilling for the others in a continuous cycle — the soil (material order) provides minerals and water; plants (bio order) grow using soil, air and sunlight; animals and humans eat plants and breathe oxygen; and waste and remains return nutrients to the soil, so the cycle continues. Nothing is wasted and nothing stands alone. Harmony does not mean sameness — each distinct order plays its part in a way that supports and completes the others; disturb one order significantly (destroy soil health or forests) and the fulfilment of every other order, including the human order, is affected. The sequence of abundance also supports this: the material order is the most abundant, then bio, then animal, and the human order is the least abundant — the base naturally serves the top.

Role of animals and birds in the bio order's fulfilment: (1) pollination — bees, butterflies and birds carry pollen from flower to flower, enabling plants to reproduce (the honeybee collects nectar for itself while pollinating the flower, without either being harmed); (2) seed dispersal — birds eat fruits and disperse seeds over a wide area, helping new plants grow; (3) manure — animal waste returns nutrients to the soil, enriching it for plants. In return, plants provide animals and birds with food, shelter and oxygen.

Self-regulation in nature: the four orders inherently maintain harmony and balance among themselves without any external control — each unit takes only as much as it needs, and the cycles of nature (water cycle, food chains, nutrient cycles) run automatically. For example, in a forest, the proportion of soil, plants and animals is self-regulated — it never happens that lions eat up all the deer, or the deer eat up all the grasses. The forest does not need to be regulated by human beings to be in harmony.

Units vs. space: in terms of size, every unit is limited — big or small, from an atom to the largest star — whereas space has no size; it is all-pervading and unlimited. In terms of activity, every unit is active, engaged in a definite continuous activity, whereas space is not active; it does nothing, interacts with nothing, is affected by nothing, and simply accommodates all the units. Existence is thus the co-existence of active units in all-pervading space — in harmony, not conflict.

The Human Order's Role and Responsibility

Q5. Explain the human order's unique responsibility in nature, the significance of education-sanskar for the human order, and what is meant by right utilisation, enrichment and protection of nature.

Answer: The human order's unique responsibility: a human being is the co-existence of the Self (the conscious 'I') and the Body (the material-biological unit). Only the human order can ask 'why?' — a plant grows and an animal acts by disposition, but only a human being can question, evaluate and choose whether an action is right. Because we alone can understand harmony, we alone are responsible for preserving or disturbing it: the other orders participate automatically, we participate consciously. Every professional decision — engineer, teacher, doctor — is a choice about sustaining or disrupting this harmony.

Harmony is a fact; participating in it is a choice: the material, plant and animal orders act spontaneously — they are automatically in harmony; a river does not choose to flow, a tree does not choose to grow towards light, and they cannot act otherwise. The human order has consciousness and choice — the freedom to select its actions — so harmony for us is not automatic; it must be understood, willed and lived.

Significance of education-sanskar: since the human order has choice (through the conscious Self with desire, thought and expectation), it can either participate in harmony or be in contradiction. Therefore the human order needs education-sanskar: education to develop right understanding of harmony at all levels — self, family, society, nature/existence — and sanskar to develop the basic acceptances of living accordingly. Through education-sanskar we ensure right understanding, which ensures right feeling; with right understanding and right feeling we ensure the continuity of harmony and happiness in ourselves and can then be a source of education-sanskar for the next generation — so the cycle continues generation after generation. Without it, humans remain in contradiction — exploiting nature, causing resource depletion, pollution and imbalance.

Right utilisation, enrichment and protection of nature: protection means safeguarding the continuity of nature — preventing deforestation, soil erosion and pollution of rivers; enrichment means improving the quantity and quality of nature — planting trees, water harvesting, composting; right utilisation means using natural resources according to real need, in limited quantity, for nurturing, protecting and rightly utilising the body — not hoarding or wasting. While interacting with any unit of nature, our participation (value) is ensuring mutual fulfilment by way of its right utilisation in accordance with its natural characteristic, so that it can continue with its innateness and inheritance — this results in prosperity for the human being and preservation (protection and enrichment) of the rest of nature. **Example:** a farmer who rotates crops and lets soil recover is deliberately participating in nature's self-organising capacity;

one who repeatedly over-extracts from the same land is in contradiction with it — even though the harm shows up only years later.

Human Participation in Harmony

Q6. 'Harmony is a fact; participating in it is a choice.' Explain the four kinds of human participation in harmony with everyday examples, and state why the comprehensive understanding of existence matters.

Answer: The material, plant and animal orders act spontaneously and are automatically in harmony — they cannot act otherwise. The human order alone has consciousness and choice, so harmony for us must be understood, willed and lived. Participation means choosing to act in line with the harmony that already exists.

The four kinds of human participation:

1. With the Self: keeping body and self in harmony — sleep, discipline, honest self-evaluation instead of distraction or self-neglect. A person acting in contradiction with the self lives in constant unease; participation brings inner ease.

2. With the family / society: right relationship — trust, respect and affection in the family, and contributing to society rather than only taking from it. Example: ignoring family to stay on the phone is contradiction; giving undivided time and attention at home is participation. The shared family meal — cooked and eaten together, everyone contributing, no one left out — is trust, respect and relationship in practice.

3. With nature: using material and biological resources responsibly — not wasting water, food or electricity in the hostel or at home. Example: leaving taps running is contradiction; using only what is needed and fixing leaks is participation. Littering the campus is contradiction; disposing of waste responsibly and segregating it is participation.

4. With existence as a whole: recognising that every choice ripples outward — a small daily habit either supports or disturbs the larger balance. Example: competing to put others down is contradiction; competing while respecting and helping peers is participation.

Comprehensive knowledge about existence is the outcome: seeing all four orders together with my own responsible place among them — existence as the co-existence of the four orders, related to one another in space in a mutually fulfilling, interconnected, self-regulating, recyclable relationship, with the human being, once aware, willingly participating in and upholding that harmony.

Why it matters: (1) Sustainability — it guides responsible use of natural resources instead of exploitative use; (2) family and social harmony — it grounds trust, respect and cooperation in relationships; (3) personal well-being — participation brings inner ease; and (4) it bridges to professional ethics (Module 5): one who can act in harmony personally can extend the same to one's future profession.

The Partial View vs. The Comprehensive View of Existence

Q7. What is meant by existence? Distinguish between the partial (fragmented) view and the comprehensive view of nature, with real-world examples of the consequences of each.

Answer: Existence is everything that is — all material things, all living beings, and the space in which they exist, all functioning together as one interrelated whole. It is comprehensive, interconnected and self-organised — not a random collection of separate objects.

The partial (fragmented) view: sees nature as separate objects — rocks, trees, animals, humans — unrelated to each other; treats humans as separate from or superior to nature, free to exploit it; studies each thing in isolation (a tree, a river, a mineral) without seeing the relationship between them; and leads to fragmented, short-term decisions such as pollution, deforestation and resource depletion.

The comprehensive view: sees nature as one interconnected, self-organised whole in which every part is related to every other part; understands the human being as an integral part of nature, participating in it rather than standing outside it; recognises four distinct orders (Material, Bio, Animal, Human), each with its own role, working together; and leads to harmony, sustainability and right participation — the basis for a value-based life.

Real-world consequences of the two views:

(1) **Deforestation for short-term profit:** the partial view sees trees only as timber/land value; the comprehensive view sees trees as sustaining soil, the water cycle, animal life and climate.

(2) **River pollution by industry:** the partial view sees the river only as a waste-disposal channel; the comprehensive view sees it as part of a living system supporting agriculture, drinking water and biodiversity.

(3) **Overuse of chemical fertilisers:** the partial view sees soil only as a medium for higher yield; the comprehensive view sees it as a living order needing long-term care for future generations.

(4) **Species extinction:** the partial view sees one species' loss as unrelated to us; the comprehensive view sees that every order's loss disturbs the interconnected balance that humans also depend on.

Thus, the partial view causes real harm — resource depletion, pollution, loss of biodiversity — while the comprehensive view is the basis of sustainable, value-based living and of the human being's right participation in existence.

Illustrations from Everyday Life and the Reference Readings

Q8. Explain harmony in nature and human participation with the help of everyday illustrations — the honeybee and the flower, the human body, crop rotation vs. over-farming, and the shared family meal. Also discuss the insights of E. F. Schumacher, Ivan Illich and Susan George.

Answer: 1. The honeybee and the flower: the bee collects nectar for itself (its own need) while pollinating the flower in the process — the animal order fulfils the plant order without either being harmed. It shows that nature's orders participate in mutual fulfilment automatically: self-interest and the other's fulfilment are not in conflict in nature.

2. The human body — all four orders in one: the body's atoms follow the material order; its cells grow and heal like the bio/plant order; its organs function like the animal order; and only you — the human order — can be aware of all this and choose. The body is thus a living example of the co-existence of the four orders.

3. Crop rotation vs. over-farming: a farmer who rotates crops and lets the soil recover is deliberately participating in nature's self-organising capacity (enrichment and protection of the material and bio orders); one who repeatedly over-extracts from the same land is in contradiction with it — even though the harm (soil degradation) shows up only years later. The two show the difference between participation and contradiction in the human order's relationship with nature.

4. The shared family meal: an ordinary daily meal cooked and eaten together — everyone contributing, no one served last or left out — is trust, respect and relationship in practice. It shows the same harmony logic scaled up from the self to the family and society: mutual fulfilment at the level of relationship.

Insights from the reference readings:

(1) **E. F. Schumacher — 'Small is Beautiful' (1973):** argues that economics built on ever-larger scale and unlimited resource use loses sight of human-scale, sustainable living — ignoring mutual fulfilment with the material and bio orders; it illustrates the consequence of a partial, exploitative view of nature.

(2) **Ivan Illich — 'Energy and Equity' (1974):** shows that, past a point, more energy consumption creates inequity rather than progress — a caution about over-drawing on the material order without balance.

(3) **Susan George — 'How the Other Half Dies' (1976):** examines how food scarcity is often not about nature's limits but about unequal, non-fulfilling participation among human beings — harmony broken within the human order itself.

Conclusion: these illustrations show that harmony in nature is real and observable everywhere — in the flower and the bee, in our own body, on the farm, and at the dining table. Nature's orders participate in mutual fulfilment automatically; the human order alone can either sustain this harmony through right participation or disturb it through contradiction. The readings warn what happens when the partial view drives human systems — and thereby underline why the comprehensive understanding of existence matters.

The Four Orders in Detail — Activity, Innateness, Natural Characteristic and Inheritance

Q9. Explain the four orders of nature on the basis of activity, innateness, natural characteristic and inheritance. Bring out the significance of education-sanskar for the human order, the dependence of the human being on the other three orders, and the mutually fulfilling interaction of the human order in nature.

Answer: The four orders can be studied in detail on the basis of four parameters: **activity** (the internal activity in the unit, based on its self-organisation), **innateness** (the definite self-organisation of a unit, by virtue of which it exhibits a definite conduct; the unit is self-regulated and a unit and its innateness are inseparable), **natural characteristic** (the natural participation of a unit in the larger order), and **inheritance** (the way units ensure the continuity of their definite conduct, generation after generation).

Activity: physical order (soil, metal) — formation-deformation; bio order (plants, trees) — the same plus respiration; animal order — the same, plus activity in the body, plus selecting-tasting in the Self; human order — the same, plus activity in the body, plus imaging, analysing-comparing, selecting-tasting in the Self, and the potential for contemplation, understanding and realisation in the Self.

Innateness: physical order — existence; bio order — existence plus growth; animal order — the same in the body, plus the will to live in the Self; human order — the same in the body, plus the will to live with continuous happiness, right feeling and right thought in the Self.

Natural characteristic: physical order — composition-based; bio order — the same plus nurture/worsen, seed-based; animal order — the same in the body, plus cruelty or non-cruelty in the Self; human order — the same in the body, plus perseverance, bravery, generosity and right understanding in the Self.

Inheritance: physical order — constitution-based; bio order — seed-based; animal order — breed-based; human order — education-sanskar.

Definite conduct: all orders, except the human order, exhibit definite conduct — through constitution-based, seed-based and breed-based inheritance respectively. The Self of the human being operating on the basis of assuming without knowing is the source of indefiniteness and the problems thereof; its solution is to ensure knowing — with right understanding, human beings can also have definite conduct. This is why human education-sanskar is required.

Significance of education-sanskar: through education and sanskar we ensure right understanding in us, which in turn ensures right feeling in us. With right understanding and right feeling in the Self, we ensure the continuity of harmony and happiness in ourselves and live accordingly; we can then be a source of human education-sanskar for the next generation, and once this cycle is complete, it can continue generation after generation.

Dependence of orders: the physical order can exist and sustain itself without support from other orders; the bio order is dependent on the physical order for its existence; the animal order is dependent on the physical order (air, water) and on the bio order for food; and the human order is dependent on all the other three orders for its existence and survival. If the human being does not ensure a relationship of mutual fulfilment with the other three orders, it is certainly going to face the negative consequences.

Mutually fulfilling interaction of the human order: the human being's role in nature is to (1) facilitate a conducive environment for the activities of all the four orders (or at least not violate them); (2) facilitate the innateness of all the four orders (or at least not violate it); (3) participate with its natural characteristic and facilitate the natural characteristic of all the four orders (or at least not violate it); and (4) ensure the inheritance of all the four orders (or at least not violate it). Studying the four orders in this way helps us clearly identify our role (participation or value) in the whole of nature.

The Holistic Perception of Harmony in Existence

Q10. What is meant by 'existence is co-existence'? Explain units and space, submergence and its implications, the two types of units, development in the existential sense, the expression of co-existence at different levels, and the role of the human being in existence.

Answer: Existence as units in space: existence is whatever exists. There are two types of basic realities in existence — space and units; the units are in space. There are innumerable units — air, water, soil, earth, sun, moon, plants, trees, animals, birds, human beings — and the co-existence of the two is in the form of units submerged in space.

Units vs. space: units are limited in size; space is unlimited, spread all around, all-pervading, with no boundary. Units are activity, they are active — activity is always taking place within a unit and it interacts with other units; space is no-activity — there is activity only in the units.

Submergence and its three implications: units are in space, inseparable from space — wherever a unit is, space is also there. (1) Units are energised in space — every unit, right from the smallest atom to the largest planet, is energised by being in co-existence with space. (2) Units are self-organised in space — every unit is in a definite order and exhibits a definite conduct; that is how one can identify, recognise and study it. (3) Units recognise their relationship and fulfil it with every other unit in space.

Two types of units: material units and consciousness units. Material units are temporary in time; consciousness units (the Self) are continuous. All material units are composed of simpler material units:

the atom is the smallest fundamental stable material unit; atoms combine to form molecules; molecules form molecular structures, which exist as lumps or fluids; fluids nurture cells; and cells combine to form plants, the animal body and the human body. The animal order is the co-existence of the Self and the animal body; the human order is the co-existence of the Self and the human body. Material units recognise and fulfil their relationship — their conduct is definite; the human being's conduct is definite if the Self operates on the basis of assuming based on knowing, and indefinite if it operates on the basis of assuming without knowing.

Development in the existential sense: whatever we do with the material world is cyclic — it keeps changing and going back to its initial state; in that sense there is no development in the material world. Only in the human order is there the potential for development or transformation in the Self, which is not cyclic — development or permanent change is possible only in the domain of consciousness. It is in terms of (1) developing right understanding and right feeling in the Self — awakening to realisation (of co-existence), understanding (of self-organisation and harmony) and contemplation (of relationship and participation in the larger order); and (2) living on the basis of right understanding and right feeling — updating all our desires, thoughts and expectations in line with it, and expressing it in behaviour, work and participation in the larger order. This development is facilitated by education-sanskar; there is every provision in existence for it.

Expression of co-existence at different levels: the harmony we discussed at the level of the individual, family, society and nature is the systematic reflection of existence as co-existence: (1a) Self — continuous happiness through realisation of co-existence, feeling and thought of co-existence, and co-existential behaviour, work and participation; (1b) individual human being — co-existence of the Self and the Body; (2) family — feeling of co-existence (trust, respect... love) and justice, leading to an undivided society; (3) society — right understanding and right feeling, prosperity, fearlessness (trust) and co-existence, through natural laws and the universal human order; (4a) nature — mutual fulfilment among the four orders; (4b) existence — co-existence, units submerged in space.

Role of the human being in existence: the human being has a definite participation in existence — to complete the process of development through itself. All that the human being needs to do is to understand the co-existence and to live in co-existence: the Self awakens to realisation, understanding and contemplation, which guides all the activities of imagination (desire, thought, expectation). The right feeling and right thought so formed become the basis of behaviour with other human beings, work with the rest of nature, and participation in the larger order. The expansion of such behaviour from family to world family leads to an undivided society; work based on natural laws results in mutual prosperity; participation in the larger order results in the fulfilment of the human goal; and the expansion from family order to world family order leads to the universal human order.

UNIT 5

SECTION A — Short Answer Questions (2 Marks Each)

Basis for Universal Human Values

Q1. What is meant by value-based living?

Answer: Value-based living means living on the basis of right understanding, in which our participation (values) at different levels of our being is naturally expressed — in behaviour (through the values in relationship) and in work (through right utilisation, enrichment and protection of the rest of nature). Values are naturally acceptable to all human beings and conducive to human happiness; value-based living is thus a natural outcome of right understanding, with no gap between what we understand and how we live.

Q2. Name the nine values in human-human relationship (values of behaviour).

Answer: The nine values in relationship are: trust, respect, affection, care, guidance, reverence, glory, gratitude and love. Trust is the foundation value and love is the complete value. The identification of these values is based on realisation and understanding, and they are naturally acceptable in relationship.

Q3. What are the values of work? What do they result in?

Answer: Working with material things — ensuring their right utilisation, enrichment and protection — is the value of work. It results in prosperity for the human being and preservation (enrichment, protection and right utilisation) of the rest of nature.

Q4. How do universal human values naturally emerge from right understanding?

Answer: There is an innate harmony and orderliness in existence — human beings only need to understand it, not create it. Universal human values are manifestations of the truth of existence, i.e., co-existence, in various dimensions of human participation in the existential order. These values are naturally acceptable to all human beings and conducive to human happiness. Only our ignorance leads to the difficulties and confusions in appreciating and inculcating them.

Q5. What is the role of self-exploration in ethical conduct?

Answer: Self-exploration is the process through which we gain right understanding about ourselves as well as about all that exists — and this process has to continue to enable realisation and understanding. It is this right understanding that provides the basis for universal human values, their natural assimilation and the definitiveness of ethical human conduct. Self-exploration is thus the entry point of ethical conduct: through the dialogue within, on the basis of one's natural acceptance and experiential validation, we verify the proposals, update our sanskar accordingly, and live in harmony at all levels of our being — which is definite (ethical) human conduct.

Q6. What is meant by the 'development of human consciousness'?

Answer: The journey towards right understanding brings a transformation in the human being from 'animal consciousness' to 'human consciousness'. In animal consciousness, we give first priority to physical facility. As we transform to human consciousness, we are able to base our thoughts and activities on right understanding, give relationship a higher priority than physical facility, and identify our physical needs and ensure them through cyclic and mutually enriching production processes, thereby enriching the rest of nature as well.

Q7. What are the implications of value-based living at the level of the individual?

Answer: Transition towards happiness and prosperity; slowly getting rid of the contradictions and conflicts within through self-exploration — and thus getting rid of tension, frustration, depression, one-upmanship and psycho-somatic disorders — facilitating definite human conduct. The feeling of self-regulation reduces the occurrence of diseases and, in turn, the feeling of insecurity, helping the individual lead a more fulfilling life.

Q8. What are the implications of value-based living at the level of the family?

Answer: Value-based living facilitates peace and harmony in the family, with more occurrences of just and fulfilling behaviour, raising the feeling of togetherness and reducing family feuds. People feel prosperous and the feeling to nurture others grows in the families. Such harmonious living also helps reduce the consumerist behaviour in family celebrations like marriages, parties and other social functions.

Q9. What are the implications of value-based living at the level of the society?

Answer: Fearlessness and mutual trust develop in the society; discrimination on the basis of body (gender, age, race), physical facility (wealth, posts) and beliefs (isms, sects) is reduced; and solutions emerge to problems like terrorism, communalism and international conflicts. The feeling of undividedness surfaces, the fulfilment of the human goal starts getting to the fore in our plans and projects at all levels, and gradually a human order based on trustful relationships emerges.

Q10. What are the implications of value-based living at the level of nature?

Answer: The human order becomes fulfilling for the other three orders of nature. Problems of pollution and resource depletion are handled smoothly when people are able to judge their needs for physical facility appropriately and the mode of fulfilment is eco-friendly. Better methods of farming and production help cut down greenhouse gases, ozone depletion and ecological imbalance; the various species of animals and birds can be saved from extinction and forests can be replenished.

Definitiveness of (Ethical) Human Conduct

Q11. Define definite (ethical) human conduct.

Answer: Definite human conduct is the sum total of the state of harmony within, expressing itself and participating in harmony with the outside world. It emerges naturally out of right understanding and is definite for all time, place and individual.

Q12. How is the harmony in the Self expressed at all levels of our being, and with what outcomes?

Answer: The harmony in the Self is naturally expressed and extended as: harmony at the level of the Self → happiness; harmony of the Self with the Body → health at the level of the body; harmony in the family / human-human relationship → mutual happiness, justice and fearlessness; harmony with the rest of nature → mutual prosperity (prosperity for the human being and preservation of the rest of nature); and harmony with the whole of nature/existence → co-existence (mutual fulfilment).

Q13. Explain the relationship between human values, policy and character.

Answer: (1) **Human values** — the understanding of the role of the human being in existence: with right understanding, we see our natural participation at all levels of being; this participation is definite and forms the basis of ethical human conduct. (2) **Policy** — the thought of how to express (live with) human values: having identified the definite values, they become the guide to our imagination (desire, thought and expectation); the comprehensive analysis of how to live with and express these values is policy — naturally conducive to human welfare and to the welfare of every unit in existence. (3) **Character** — the expression of human values in behaviour, work and participation in the larger order.

Q14. In terms of what is human character expressed?

Answer: Human character is expressed in terms of: (1) chastity in the conjugal (husband-wife) relationship; (2) rightful acquisition and utilization of wealth — by way of labour, using cyclic and mutually enriching production processes; and (3) kindness in behaviour and work — ensuring justice in behaviour and preservation of the rest of nature in work, leading to the fulfilment of the comprehensive human goal, while at the same time compensating for the deficiencies created in the past.

Q15. State the qualifications of ethical human conduct.

Answer: (1) Ethical conduct is naturally acceptable to me and does not give rise to conflict within — it is self-satisfying. (2) It is in consonance with the right understanding of reality — the underlying harmony at all levels. (3) It leads to mutual fulfilment with other people and mutual enrichment with the rest of nature. Thus, ethical conduct is self-satisfying, people-friendly and eco-friendly for all time, place and

individual.

Professional Ethics in the Light of Right Understanding

Q16. Define profession in the context of the comprehensive human goal.

Answer: A profession is a mode of participation by human beings in the larger order in pursuance of the comprehensive human goal. The excellence or success of any professional activity is to be judged from this comprehensive point of view only, and not in terms of merely wealth generation. The profession is not only a means of earning one's livelihood, but also a means of one's evolution by appropriate participation in the larger order — an important activity to authenticate one's understanding, whereby we interact with other human beings and with the rest of nature in a mutually fulfilling manner.

Q17. What is meant by professional ethics?

Answer: Professional ethics can be seen as the code of ethical conduct of the profession. Ethical conduct of a profession implies the right utilization of one's professional skills in the larger order towards the fulfilment of the comprehensive human goal.

Q18. State the six salient features characterizing professional ethics.

Answer: (1) Clarity about the comprehensive human goal. (2) Confidence in oneself as well as confidence in the harmony, co-existence and self-regulation prevailing in the entire existence. (3) Competence of mutually fulfilling behaviour. (4) Competence of mutually enriching interaction with nature. (5) Holistic vision about technologies, production systems and management techniques. (6) Understanding of one's social responsibility.

Q19. Enlist the salient categories of unethical practices in the current professional scenario.

Answer: Corruption in multiple forms and at various levels; tax evasion, misappropriation and misuse of public funds; misuse of political power and bureaucratic authority; misleading propaganda, unethical advertisements and sales promotion; cut-throat competition; exploiting the weakness of consumers through various enticements and bewildering advertisements; adulteration and spurious production; endangering the health and safety of the public at large; and hoarding and over-charging. As a result of this 'epidemic' of unethical practices, we frequently come across serious scams, major economic offences and kickbacks in large-scale purchases.

Q20. What approaches are presently employed to check unethical practices, and why are they inadequate?

Answer: The methods presently employed include: promoting awareness about professional ethics through new courses, refresher programs and case studies; administering oaths and prescribing codes of ethical conduct; setting up mechanisms for intensive audit, inspection and monitoring; framing more stringent laws and harder punishments; promoting transparency through mechanisms like RTI; carrying out sting operations and publicising serious lapses through media; encouraging whistle blowing; setting up Lokpals, vigilance commissions, ethics committees, tribunals and consumer protection forums; and filing public interest litigations. Most of these are either of a symptomatic nature, punitive measures or crisis-management techniques — the focus is primarily towards curbing the ill effects rather than rectifying the root cause, namely the faulty world-view which continues to remain dominant.

Q21. How do inherent contradictions and dilemmas arise from the prevailing worldview?

Answer: The prevailing worldview perceives wealth maximization as the prime objective. Thus, the other person's happiness seems to be in conflict with my happiness: the other people have to be exploited for one to gain affluence, and there is no possibility of mutual fulfilment in a sustainable way. In the same way, exploitation of nature also becomes acceptable, as it helps a person accumulate wealth easily, and there is no limit to this.

Q22. What is the way ahead for safeguarding professional ethics?

Answer: To resolve the situation, sincere effort towards building up the ethical competence of human beings in general, and professionals in particular, through proper value education is needed. It can be

an effective way to safeguard professional ethics. Clarity of the comprehensive human goal and of our participation in the different dimensions of society will ensure ethics in profession.

A Basis for Humanistic Education, Humanistic Constitution and Universal Human Order

Q23. What is the vision for holistic development?

Answer: In the light of right understanding, it is possible to visualize the pattern of a holistic way of life catering to the comprehensive human goal — a model of human living which is people-friendly and eco-friendly, and therefore sustainable, conducive to fulfilling the basic human aspirations of all human beings. It will be a mode of living which is self-satisfying, people-friendly and eco-friendly. There is an urgent need to initiate research and development in this direction, as the present model of living is proving to be increasingly problematic and unsustainable.

Q24. What does the universal human order involve?

Answer: The universal human order will involve: (a) a holistic pattern in all the dimensions of human activity in society — including education, health-self-regulation, production-work, justice-preservation and exchange-storage; and (b) harmonious networking between the basic units and their clusters, successively moving from family order to world family order: Family Order → Family Cluster Order → Village Order → Village Cluster Order → ... → Nation Order → World Family Order. In each of these dimensions, we can visualize a humane system and conceptualise a harmoniously functioning overall system.

Q25. What is humanistic education? What does it facilitate?

Answer: The primary step towards the holistic way of life is to develop right understanding, commitment to live accordingly, and the requisite skills and knowledge systems — which calls for a change in the education system towards humanistic education. Humanistic education facilitates the process of self-exploration, leading to the continuous self-evolution of human beings. It enables the realisation of one's innateness as well as the universality and definitiveness of ethical human conduct, and develops the assurance that only value-based living can be conducive to continuous happiness and prosperity for one and all.

Q26. What is a humanistic constitution? What will be its salient directive principles?

Answer: Right understanding provides the basis for a humanistic constitution, which is essential to the development of an un-fragmented human society and a universal human order. Working towards the comprehensive human goal and developing the competence for ethical human conduct will be among its salient directive principles, and it will be conducive to social justice. To begin with, the family will be the smallest unit of order in the society; moving from family to the world family, the constitution will provide the basis of harmonious living.

Q27. How does humanistic education pave the way towards a humanistic tradition and universal human order?

Answer: Humanistic education leads to human conduct, human constitution and universal human order; and in turn, the universal human order ensures humanistic education for the next generation. The entry point is humanistic education. With suitable systems and policies evolved in the light of right understanding, it is possible to move towards a universal human order, and such a development will be naturally acceptable to all human beings.

Holistic Technologies, Production Systems and Management Models

Q28. Why is there a strong need for a holistic worldview in developing technologies and systems? Critically appraise the prevailing systems.

Answer: Most of the present-day effort in developing innovative technologies and systems is going on under the influence of the materialistic world-view; the holistic world-view is missing. As a result, both the structure and the use/misuse of these innovations is often proving counterproductive, contrary to

long-term human welfare. The present-day systems have caused the menace of resource depletion on one hand, and environmental degradation manifesting as pollution and global warming on the other. Other undesirable characteristics of modern technologies and systems include their centralized configurations, promotion of wastefulness, excessive transportation, and the substitution of human, animal and other natural resources by man-made gadgets, machines and materials.

Q29. State the three broad criteria for evaluating holistic technologies and systems.

Answer: (a) Catering to appropriate needs and lifestyles. (b) Eco-friendly — cyclic/renewable and mutually enriching. (c) User-friendly — safe, economical and enhancing human capability. In addition, these have to promote local self-sufficiency and optimal utilization of local resources and expertise; as far as possible, priority should be for naturally available processes and systems.

Q30. List the specific criteria for judging the appropriateness of technologies.

Answer: Catering to real human needs; compatible with natural systems and cycles; facilitating effective utilization of the human body, animals, plants and other natural materials; safe, user-friendly and conducive to health; producible with local resources and expertise as far as possible; promoting the use of renewable energy resources; low cost and energy efficient; enhancing human interaction and cooperation; promoting decentralisation; and durability, life cycle and recyclability of products.

Q31. What are the four key questions to be answered in determining production systems?

Answer: What to produce? How to produce? For whom to produce? How much to produce? All these are decided in the context of the availability of local natural resources and expertise, to cater to the needs of the people of any given community — with the needs characterised in consonance with the comprehensive human goal.

Q32. List the criteria for judging the appropriateness of production systems.

Answer: Optimal and efficient utilization of local resources and expertise (human beings, animals, air, solar, land, water, bio and mineral resources); economic viability and sustainability; priority for local consumption; matching the pattern of production with the availability/producibility in the local environment and the pattern of consumption; decentralized systems capable of meaningful employment of people in the community; facilitating production by masses, and not mass production in a centralized mode, to the extent possible; promoting individual creativity and sense of accomplishment; using people-friendly and eco-friendly technologies; ensuring requisite quality of production; safe and conducive to the health of persons involved in production as well as others; and harnessing recycling, conservation and reuse possibilities.

Q33. What is meant by a humanistic management model? State its criteria.

Answer: Management models are primarily to be relationship-based, cooperative and ensuring justice in terms of mutual fulfilment — not coercive and exploitative. The criteria for a humanistic management model are: the whole unit working as a well-knit family; cooperative, motivational and mutually fulfilling; ensuring correct appraisal of human labour and skills; targeting employer-employee as well as consumer satisfaction, and not profit maximisation; sharing of responsibility and a participative mode of management; continuous value addition of the persons involved; and effectively integrating individual competencies and complementarity.

Q34. What can we learn from the systems in nature and traditional practices? Give examples.

Answer: To gain insight into holistic systems, we have a lot to learn from the systems in nature and from traditional practices — identifying the eco-friendly and people-friendly characteristics of many traditional practices which are worthy of recognition and retention, and then using present-day information to augment them and make them more effective, efficient and suited to current needs. Significant examples: the water harvesting, storage and utilization systems through ponds; traditional agricultural practices; traditional local remedies and health-care techniques; grain storage and food preservation practices; yoga, ayurveda and naturopathy-based healthcare systems; the langar (sharing of food) system prevalent in religious institutions; family-based rural enterprises; the jajmani system

(relationship-based village system ensuring rural self-sufficiency); and rural craft and artisanal practices.

Q35. What is meant by visualizing a holistic community model (gram-swarajya)? Name the salient topics for case studies.

Answer: It is high time to start working for the actualization of the model of human order at the village level (gram-swarajya) in the light of right understanding. Several groups have started working in this direction and many technologies and systems have been evolved, though the full-scale demonstration of such alternative ways of living is yet to emerge. Salient topics for case studies: (1) renewable and decentralized energy technologies — biomass-based energy conversion systems, gadgets and implements for efficient utilization of human muscle power and animal draught power, decentralized wind power, and micro hydel electro-mechanical power generation; (2) systems for water conservation and watershed management for efficient utilization of rain water and eco-restoration; (3) technologies and architecture promoting green building materials and energy conservation; (4) organic/natural farming techniques; (5) eco-sanitation techniques for small-scale decentralized sewage disposal and waste water recycling; (6) low-cost and energy-efficient technologies for small-scale production systems; and (7) humanistic organizational/management models.

Strategies for Transition towards Value-based Life and Profession

Q36. State the core message of the course.

Answer: To be able to fulfil the basic human aspirations — happiness and prosperity, and their continuity — it is essential to gain the right understanding: the understanding about oneself vis-à-vis the rest of existence, and the understanding about continuous happiness and prosperity. This involves the realisation that there is an innate harmony at all levels of existence — the whole existence is co-existence. It is the essential purpose of human beings to understand this harmony and co-existence, and learn to live in accordance with it and be fulfilled.

Q37. What two transformations does the core message of the course lead to?

Answer: (1) **Individual transformation** — from animal consciousness to human consciousness. (2) **Societal transformation** — from inhuman society to humane society.

Q38. State the three sub-steps for individual transformation (Step 1).

Answer: (1) Verify the proposals on your own right — on the basis of your natural acceptance and on the basis of your experiential validation. (2) Be aware of yourself, and of your imagination (desire, thought and expectation) every moment — with this awareness, you know the content of your imagination and of all the accumulated acceptances which are your sanskar. (3) Self-evaluation — evaluate your sanskar vis-à-vis your natural acceptance. Recall: $\text{sanskar}(t) + \text{environment}(t) + \text{self-exploration}(t) \rightarrow \text{sanskar}(t+1)$. These sub-steps may take a long time, but each proposal that you are able to verify and bring into your living will be immediately fulfilling for you and for those around you.

Q39. Whom should you share with, and how, while creating mass awareness towards holistic development (Step 2)?

Answer: With right understanding and right feeling in you, you develop the willingness and capacity to share with others — facilitating and developing other people to have the right understanding, right feeling and right thought — in the form of informal talks and formal workshops. The people to share with include: family members and friends; people who have interest and readiness for purposeful social effort and social development; educators, teachers and education administrators; people connected to governance; and colleagues at work. To start with, it is important to share only with those who are already willing to listen — if you start this step before you have done sufficient work on yourself, people may not be able to accept you as a preceptor.

Q40. State the sub-steps for moving towards humanising the mainstream education (Step 3).

Answer: (1) Integrating appropriate inputs of value education at various levels in the current curricula, from school education to higher education. (2) Requisite support and policy initiatives by monitoring

agencies such as MHRD, UGC, AICTE, ICMR, University Academic Councils and School Education Boards. (3) Introducing teacher orientation programs (faculty development programs) and developing resource material to implement the effort at a large scale. (4) Providing adequate thrust to R&D; dedicated towards transforming the whole mainstream education into humanistic (value-based) education — a long-drawn process, but indispensable.

Q41. What does developing models for holistic living involve (Step 4)?

Answer: Developing models for holistic living in educational institutions and in the community — linking the educational institutions with local development programs, in collaboration with voluntary organisations and government agencies. Accordingly, the focus of R&D; in higher education institutions will need to be shifted towards the various aspects of holistic development, resulting in the development of real-life models facilitating the universal human order.

SECTION B — Long/Descriptive Answer Questions (7 Marks Each)

Basis for Universal Human Values and Value-based Living

Q1. Explain how universal human values emerge naturally from right understanding, distinguishing between values of behaviour and values of work, and describe the development of human consciousness along with the implications of value-based living at the levels of the individual, family, society and nature.

Answer: Basis in right understanding: based on our understanding of harmony, we participate in the larger order, and our participation at different levels is our value — identified on the basis of realisation and understanding. There is an innate harmony and orderliness in existence; human beings only need to understand it, not create it. Universal human values are manifestations of the truth of existence — co-existence — in various dimensions of human participation in the existential order. They are naturally acceptable to all and conducive to happiness; only our ignorance creates difficulties in appreciating and inculcating them.

Values of behaviour and values of work: the participation of the human being is in the form of behaviour and work. The values of behaviour are the nine values in relationship — trust, respect, affection, care, guidance, reverence, glory, gratitude and love (trust the foundation value, love the complete value). The values of work are right utilisation, enrichment and protection of material things — resulting in prosperity for the human being and preservation of the rest of nature.

Development of human consciousness: the journey towards right understanding transforms the human being from 'animal consciousness' (first priority to physical facility) to 'human consciousness' (thoughts and activities based on right understanding, relationship given higher priority than physical facility, physical needs identified and ensured through cyclic and mutually enriching production processes, enriching the rest of nature as well).

Implications of value-based living:

At the level of the individual: transition towards happiness and prosperity; getting rid of contradictions and conflicts within through self-exploration — ridding oneself of tension, frustration, depression, one-upmanship and psycho-somatic disorders — facilitating definite human conduct; the feeling of self-regulation reduces diseases and insecurity, leading to a more fulfilling life.

At the level of the family: peace and harmony, more just and fulfilling behaviour, greater togetherness, fewer family feuds; people feel prosperous and the feeling to nurture others grows; consumerist behaviour in celebrations reduces.

At the level of the society: fearlessness and mutual trust; reduction of discrimination on the basis of body, physical facility and beliefs; solutions to terrorism, communalism and international conflicts; the feeling of undividedness; the human goal coming to the fore in plans and projects, and a human order based on trustful relationships gradually emerging.

At the level of nature: the human order becomes fulfilling for the other three orders; pollution and resource depletion handled smoothly; eco-friendly fulfilment of appropriately-judged needs; better farming and production cutting down greenhouse gases, ozone depletion and ecological imbalance; species saved from extinction and forests replenished.

Definitiveness of (Ethical) Human Conduct

Q2. Explain the definitiveness of ethical human conduct — how harmony is expressed at all levels of being, how ethical conduct is grasped in terms of values, policy and character, and the

qualifications of ethical conduct.

Answer: Definition: definite human conduct is the sum total of the state of harmony within, expressing itself and participating in harmony with the outside world. It emerges naturally out of right understanding and is definite for all time, place and individual.

Expression at all levels of being: harmony at the level of the Self → happiness; harmony of the Self with the Body → health; harmony in the family / human-human relationship → mutual happiness, justice and fearlessness; harmony with the rest of nature → mutual prosperity (prosperity for the human being and preservation of the rest of nature); harmony with the whole of nature/existence → co-existence (mutual fulfilment).

Values, policy and character: (1) **Human values** — the understanding of the role of the human being in existence: with right understanding we see our definite natural participation at all levels of being, which forms the basis of ethical human conduct. (2) **Policy** — the thought of how to express and live with these values: they guide our imagination (desire, thought and expectation); the comprehensive analysis of how to live with them is policy — conducive to the enrichment, protection and right utilization of self, body and physical resources, and to the welfare of every unit in existence. (3) **Character** — the expression of human values in behaviour, work and participation in the larger order, expressed as: chastity in the conjugal (husband-wife) relationship; rightful acquisition and utilization of wealth by way of labour, using cyclic and mutually enriching production processes; and kindness in behaviour and work — ensuring justice in behaviour and preservation of the rest of nature in work, leading to the fulfilment of the comprehensive human goal while compensating for deficiencies created in the past.

Qualifications of ethical conduct: it is naturally acceptable to me and does not give rise to conflict within (self-satisfying); it is in consonance with the right understanding of reality — the underlying harmony at all levels; and it leads to mutual fulfilment with other people and mutual enrichment with the rest of nature. Thus ethical conduct is self-satisfying, people-friendly and eco-friendly for all time, place and individual.

Professional Ethics in the Light of Right Understanding

Q3. Explain professional ethics in the light of right understanding — the meaning of profession, the definition and salient features of professional ethics, the issues in the current scenario, the inadequacy of the prevailing approaches, the inherent contradictions, and the way ahead.

Answer: Profession in the context of the comprehensive human goal: a profession is a mode of participation by human beings in the larger order in pursuance of the comprehensive human goal. Its excellence or success is to be judged from this comprehensive point of view, not merely in terms of wealth generation. The profession is not only a means of earning one's livelihood but also a means of one's evolution by appropriate participation in the larger order — an important activity to authenticate one's understanding, interacting with other human beings and the rest of nature in a mutually fulfilling manner.

Professional ethics: the code of ethical conduct of the profession — implying the right utilization of one's professional skills in the larger order towards the fulfilment of the comprehensive human goal.

Salient features: (1) clarity about the comprehensive human goal; (2) confidence in oneself and in the harmony, co-existence and self-regulation prevailing in entire existence; (3) competence of mutually fulfilling behaviour; (4) competence of mutually enriching interaction with nature; (5) holistic vision about technologies, production systems and management techniques; (6) understanding of one's social responsibility.

Issues in the current scenario: unethical practices are rapidly increasing and their impact is far-reaching — serious scams, major economic offences, kickbacks in large-scale purchases. The

salient categories: corruption; tax evasion, misappropriation and misuse of public funds; misuse of political power and bureaucratic authority; misleading propaganda and unethical advertisements; cut-throat competition; exploiting the weakness of consumers; adulteration and spurious production; endangering public health and safety; hoarding and over-charging.

Prevailing approaches and their inadequacy: ethics courses and case studies; oaths and codes of conduct; audit and monitoring; stringent laws and harder punishments; transparency mechanisms like RTI; sting operations and media publicity; whistle blowing; Lokpals, vigilance commissions, ethics committees, tribunals, consumer forums; public interest litigations. Most of these are symptomatic, punitive or crisis-management measures — focused on curbing the ill effects rather than rectifying the root cause: the faulty world-view that remains dominant.

Inherent contradictions: in the prevailing worldview of wealth maximization, the other person's happiness seems to be in conflict with my happiness — others have to be exploited for one to gain affluence, with no possibility of sustainable mutual fulfilment; exploitation of nature also becomes acceptable for accumulating wealth, with no limit to it.

The way ahead: sincere effort towards building up the ethical competence of human beings in general and professionals in particular, through proper value education — an effective way to safeguard professional ethics.

Humanistic Education, Humanistic Constitution and Universal Human Order

Q4. Explain the vision for holistic development and universal human order, and show how humanistic education and humanistic constitution form the basis for moving towards it.

Answer: Vision for holistic development: right understanding enables the visualization of the comprehensive human goal and a holistic way of life catering to it — a model of living that is self-satisfying, people-friendly and eco-friendly, and therefore sustainable and conducive to fulfilling the basic human aspirations of all. There is an urgent need for R&D; in this direction, as the present model of living is proving increasingly problematic and unsustainable.

Universal human order: it will involve (a) a holistic pattern in all dimensions of human activity in society — education, health-self-regulation, production-work, justice-preservation and exchange-storage; and (b) harmonious networking between the basic units and their clusters, successively from Family Order → Family Cluster Order → Village Order → Village Cluster Order → ... → Nation Order → World Family Order. In each dimension we can visualize a humane system and conceptualise a harmoniously functioning overall system.

Humanistic education: the primary step towards the holistic way of life is to develop right understanding, commitment to live accordingly, and the requisite skills and knowledge systems — calling for a change in the education system. Humanistic education facilitates self-exploration, leading to continuous self-evolution; it enables the realisation of one's innateness as well as the universality and definitiveness of ethical human conduct; and it develops the assurance that only value-based living is conducive to continuous happiness and prosperity for one and all.

Humanistic constitution: right understanding also provides the basis for a humanistic constitution, essential to the development of an un-fragmented human society and a universal human order. Working towards the comprehensive human goal and developing the competence for ethical human conduct will be among its salient directive principles, and it will be conducive to social justice. The family will be the smallest unit of order; moving from family to the world family, the constitution will provide the basis of harmonious living. Thought-provoking issues to address include: what the fundamental rights and duties will be, how justice and protection will be ensured, the format of working for a universal human order,

how people will connect to the world family, and how the representation of people will be ensured in maintaining order in society.

The chain: humanistic education leads to human conduct, human constitution, universal human order; and in turn, the universal human order ensures humanistic education for the next generation. The entry point is humanistic education — with suitable systems and policies evolved in the light of right understanding, it is possible to move towards the universal human order, which will be naturally acceptable to all human beings.

Holistic Technologies, Production Systems and Management Models

Q5. Explain the need for a holistic worldview in developing technologies and systems, the three broad criteria for their evaluation, and the specific criteria for technologies, production systems and management models. Also discuss what we can learn from the systems in nature and traditional practices, and the vision of a holistic community model (gram-swarajya).

Answer: Need for a holistic worldview: most present-day innovation proceeds under the influence of the materialistic worldview — the holistic world-view is missing. As a result, both the structure and the use/misuse of these innovations is often counterproductive, contrary to long-term human welfare: resource depletion, environmental degradation (pollution, global warming), centralized configurations, promotion of wastefulness, excessive transportation, and substitution of human, animal and natural resources by man-made gadgets. Hence there is a strong need to develop technologies and systems with holistic objectives governed by right understanding.

Three broad criteria for evaluation: (a) catering to appropriate needs and lifestyles; (b) eco-friendly — cyclic/renewable and mutually enriching; (c) user-friendly — safe, economical and enhancing human capability — in addition promoting local self-sufficiency and optimal utilization of local resources and expertise, with priority for naturally available processes and systems.

Criteria for technologies: catering to real human needs; compatible with natural systems and cycles; facilitating effective utilization of the human body, animals, plants and natural materials; safe, user-friendly and conducive to health; producible with local resources and expertise; promoting renewable energy; low cost and energy efficient; enhancing human interaction and cooperation; promoting decentralisation; durability, life cycle and recyclability.

Criteria for production systems: the four key questions — what to produce, how to produce, for whom to produce, how much to produce — are decided in the context of local resources and expertise, with needs characterised in consonance with the comprehensive human goal. Specific criteria: optimal utilization of local resources and expertise; economic viability and sustainability; priority for local consumption; matching production patterns with local availability and consumption; decentralized systems capable of meaningful employment; production by masses rather than mass production; promoting individual creativity and sense of accomplishment; people-friendly and eco-friendly technologies; requisite quality; safety and health; harnessing recycling, conservation and reuse.

Criteria for management models: relationship-based, cooperative and ensuring justice in terms of mutual fulfilment — not coercive and exploitative: the whole unit working as a well-knit family; cooperative, motivational and mutually fulfilling; correct appraisal of human labour and skills; employer-employee and consumer satisfaction rather than profit maximisation; sharing of responsibility and participative management; continuous value addition of the persons involved; and integrating individual competencies and complementarity.

Learning from nature and traditional practices: water harvesting systems through ponds; traditional agricultural practices; local remedies and health-care techniques; grain storage and food preservation;

yoga, ayurveda and naturopathy-based healthcare; the langar system; family-based rural enterprises; the jajmani system; rural craft and artisanal practices — identifying their eco-friendly and people-friendly characteristics worthy of recognition and retention, and augmenting them with present-day information.

Holistic community model (gram-swarajya): working for the actualization of the model of human order at the village level, with dedicated R&D; efforts within the framework of right understanding. Salient topics for case studies include: renewable and decentralized energy technologies (biomass, human muscle and animal draught power gadgets, decentralized wind, micro hydel); water conservation and watershed management; green building materials and energy conservation; organic/natural farming; eco-sanitation and waste water recycling; low-cost, energy-efficient small-scale production systems; and humanistic organizational/management models.

Strategies for Transition towards Value-based Life and Profession

Q6. State the core message of the course, and explain the strategies (four steps) for the transition towards a value-based life and profession, leading to the universal human order.

Answer: The core message: to fulfil the basic human aspirations — happiness and prosperity with continuity — it is essential to gain right understanding about oneself vis-à-vis the rest of existence and about continuous happiness and prosperity. This involves the realisation that there is an innate harmony at all levels of existence — the whole existence is co-existence — and that it is the essential purpose of human beings to understand this harmony and live in accordance with it. This leads to individual transformation (from animal consciousness to human consciousness) and societal transformation (from inhuman society to humane society).

Step 1 — Individual transformation: (1) verify the proposals on your own right, on the basis of your natural acceptance and experiential validation; (2) be aware of yourself and of your imagination (desire, thought and expectation) every moment — knowing the content of your imagination and your accumulated acceptances (sanskar); (3) self-evaluation — evaluate your sanskar vis-à-vis your natural acceptance. Recall: $\text{sanskar}(t) + \text{environment}(t) + \text{self-exploration}(t) \rightarrow \text{sanskar}(t+1)$. Each proposal verified and brought into living is immediately fulfilling for you and those around you.

Step 2 — Creating mass awareness towards holistic development: with right understanding and right feeling, develop the willingness and capacity to share with others — through informal talks and formal workshops — with family members and friends, people ready for purposeful social effort, educators and education administrators, people connected to governance, and colleagues at work. To start with, share only with those already willing to listen.

Step 3 — Moving towards humanising the mainstream education: (1) integrating appropriate inputs of value education at various levels of the current curricula, from school to higher education; (2) support and policy initiatives by monitoring agencies such as MHRD, UGC, AICTE, ICMR, University Academic Councils and School Education Boards; (3) teacher orientation programs (faculty development programs) and development of resource material; (4) an adequate thrust to R&D; dedicated to transforming mainstream education into humanistic (value-based) education — long-drawn but indispensable.

Step 4 — Developing models for holistic living: developing models in educational institutions and in the community, linking institutions with local development programs in collaboration with voluntary organisations and government agencies, and shifting the focus of R&D; in higher education towards aspects of holistic development — resulting in real-life models facilitating the universal human order.

Conclusion: to ensure happiness and prosperity with continuity for all human beings, the transition to human consciousness and a humane society is essential — requiring a dedicated effort to implement,

at a mass scale, humanistic education focusing on right understanding.